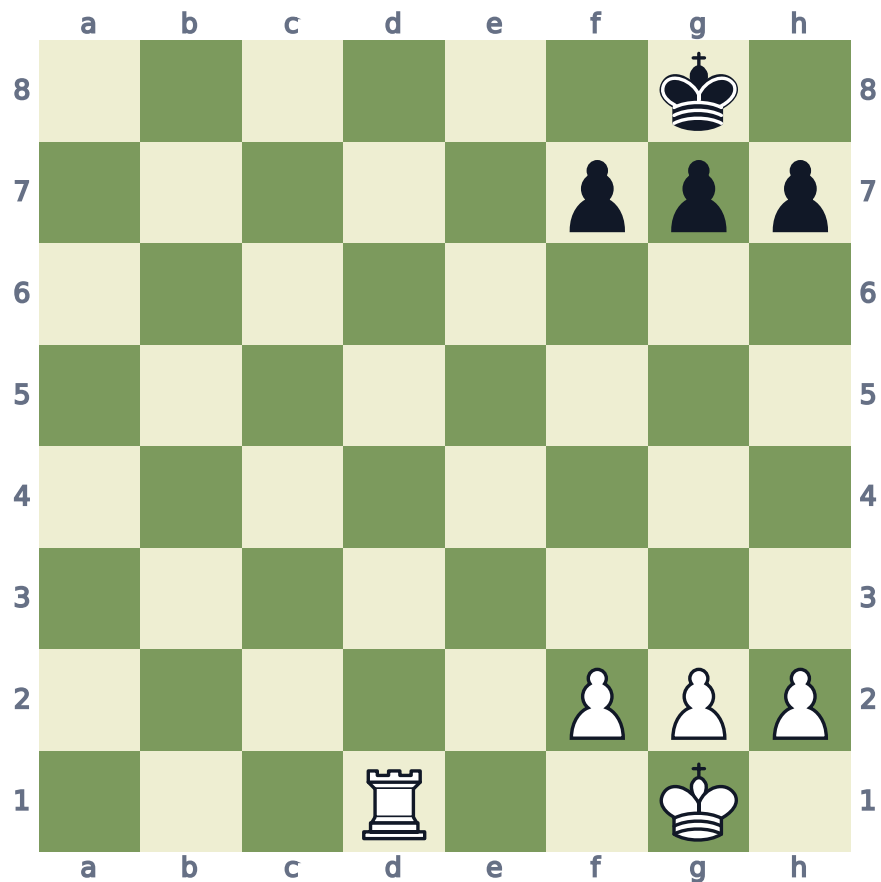


Tactics by Difficulty

A progressive ladder from one-move recognition to combination



Develop tactical vision in rating bands, with engine-checked lines, full-answer scoring, and mixed review that prevents motif-name guessing.

32 practice units | separated solutions | scoring | review plan

ORIENTATION

How to get real improvement from this course

PURPOSE

Develop tactical vision in rating bands, with engine-checked lines, full-answer scoring, and mixed review that prevents motif-name guessing.

TRAINING RULES

- Do not move the pieces until you have written or spoken your complete answer.
- Record candidates before calculation so a correct guess cannot hide a weak process.
- Search for the opponent's strongest resistance, not the reply you hope to see.
- Score the process as well as the move, then schedule missed positions for retrieval.
- Repeat from the opposite side when possible; recognition must survive a changed orientation.
-

COURSE SIZE

This PDF contains 32 practice units. Problems appear before their solutions whenever practical. Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days.

SCORING

What a complete answer contains

RECOGNITION

Name the tactical or strategic feature without assuming that the familiar pattern works.

CANDIDATES

List serious forcing and improving choices before analyzing deeply.

BEST RESISTANCE

Calculate the opponent's least cooperative legal response.

ENDPOINT

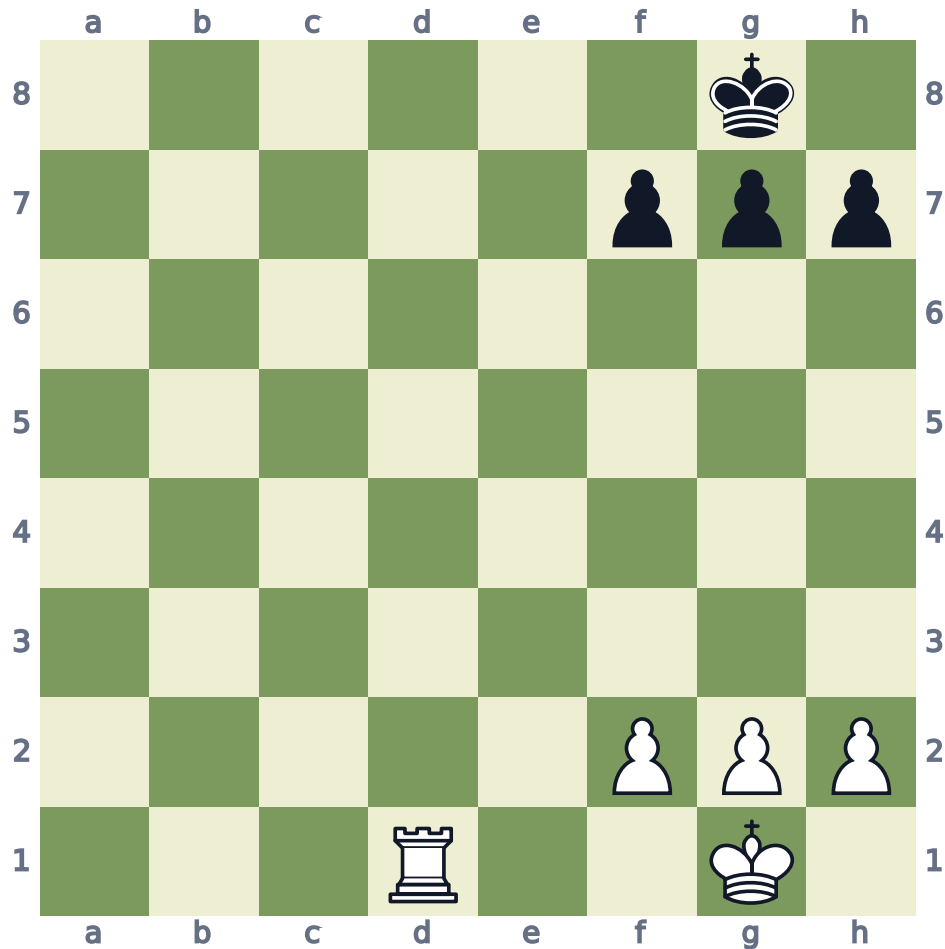
Stop only after forcing play settles, then evaluate material, kings, activity, and structure.

TRANSFER

State the visible cue that should make you remember this position during a game.

PROBLEM 01 OF 32

Back-rank mate



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

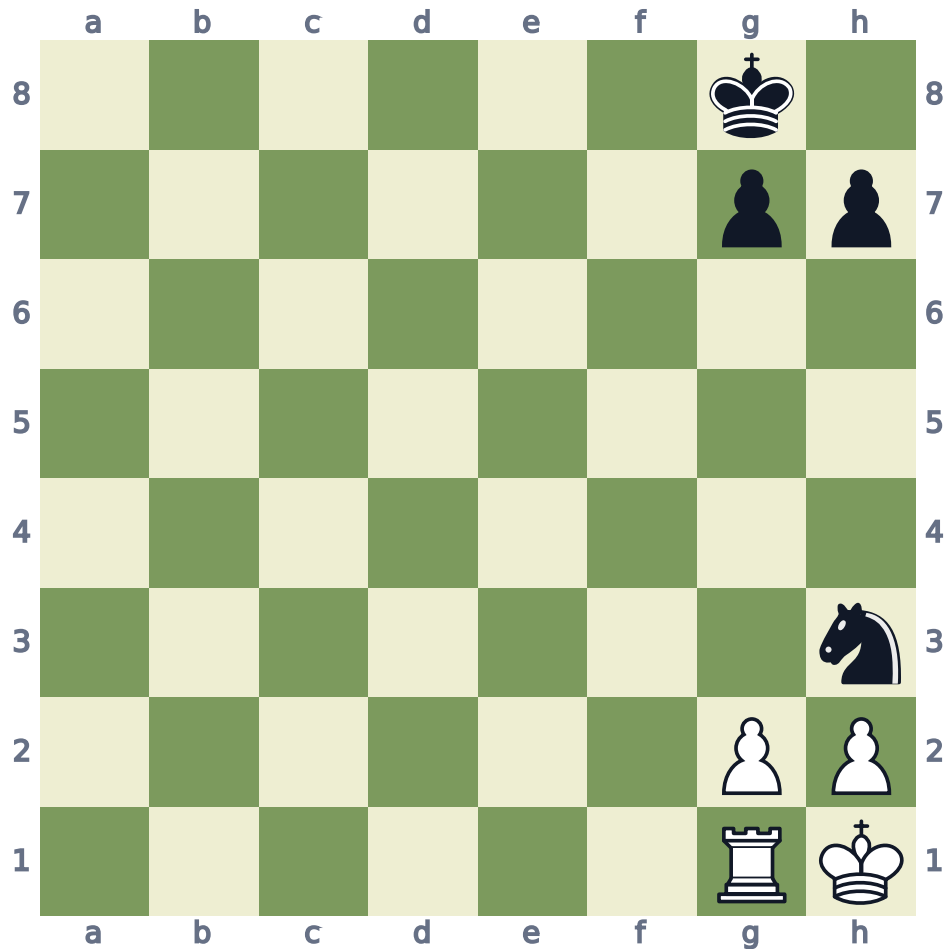
Foundation mate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 02 OF 32

Smothered mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

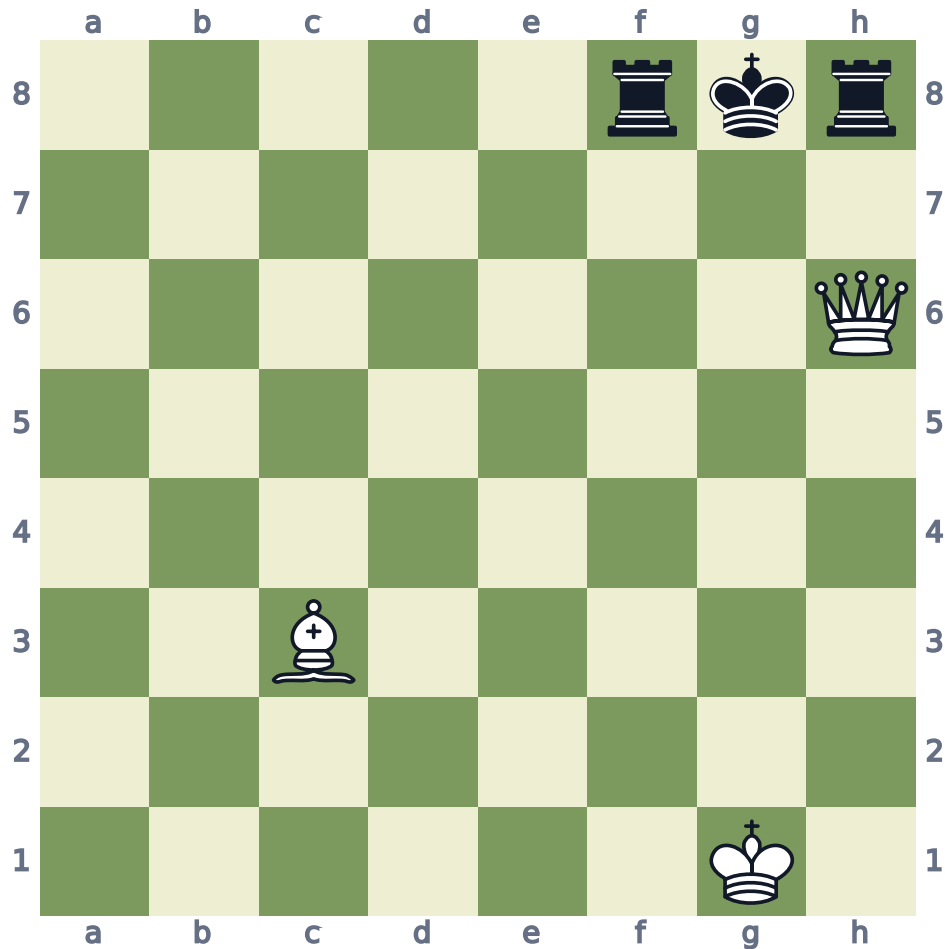
Foundation mate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 03 OF 32

Epaulette mate



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

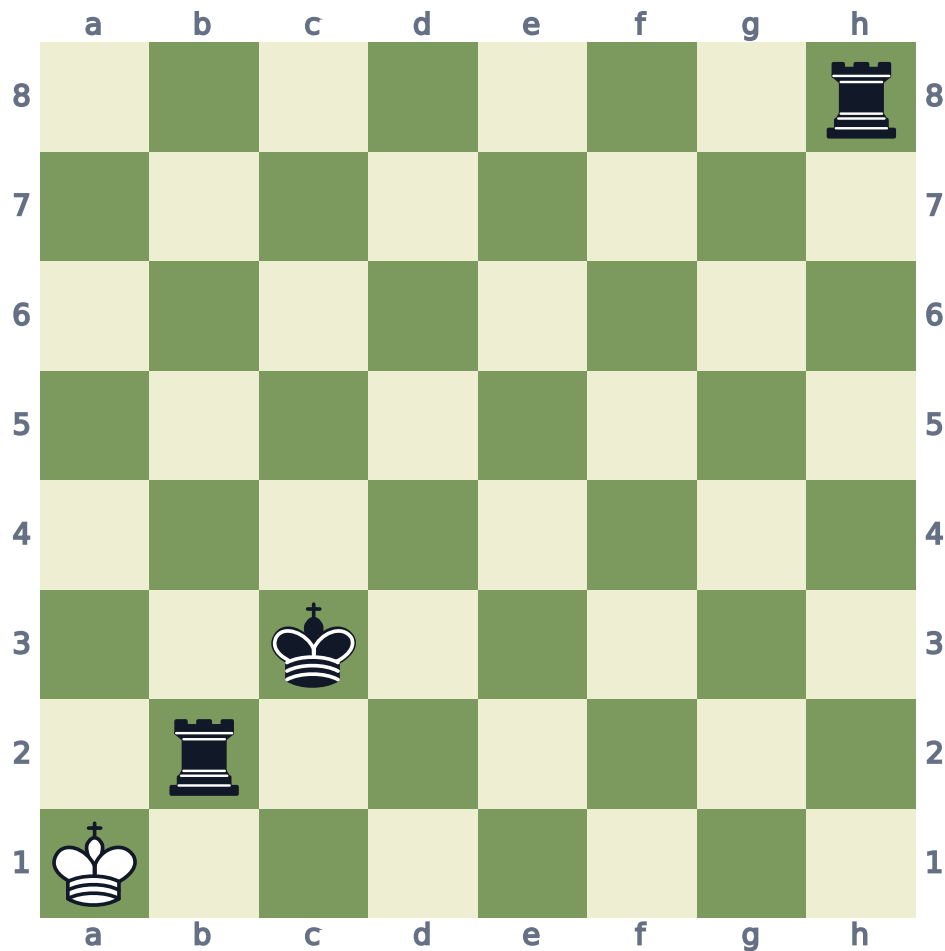
Foundation mate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 04 OF 32

Ladder mate - reversed colors

**YOUR TASK**

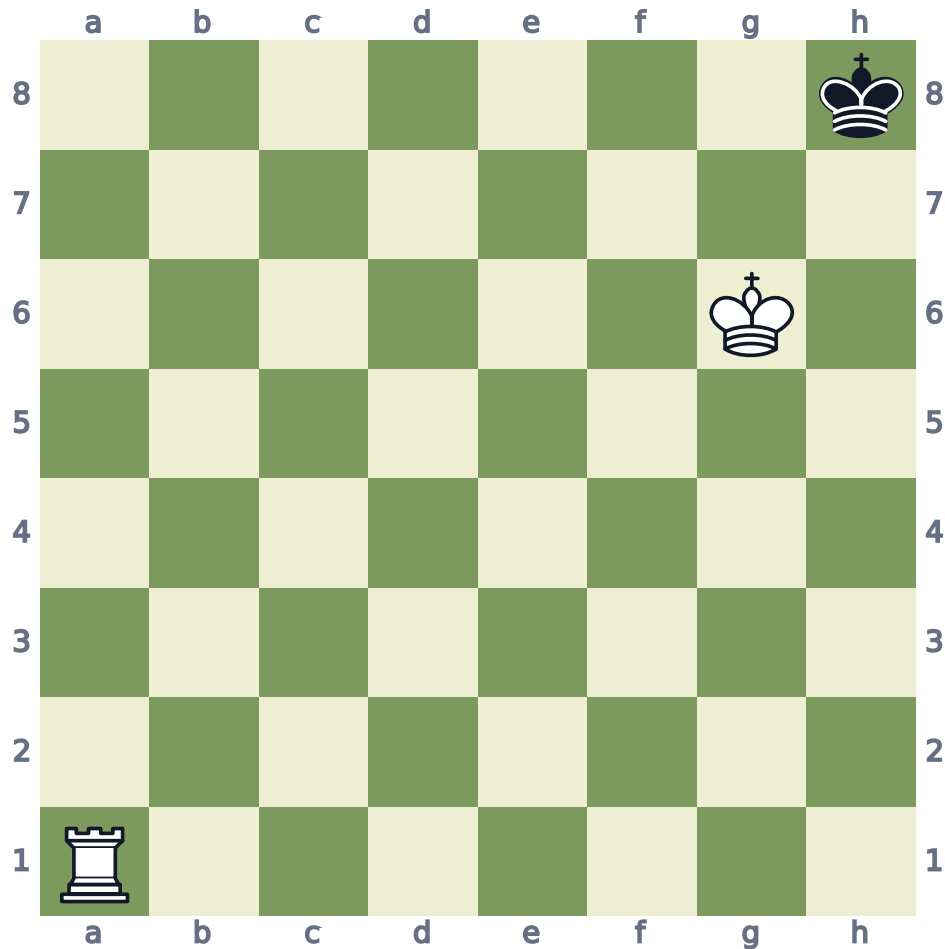
Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY**Foundation mate****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 05 OF 32

Rook box mate

**YOUR TASK**

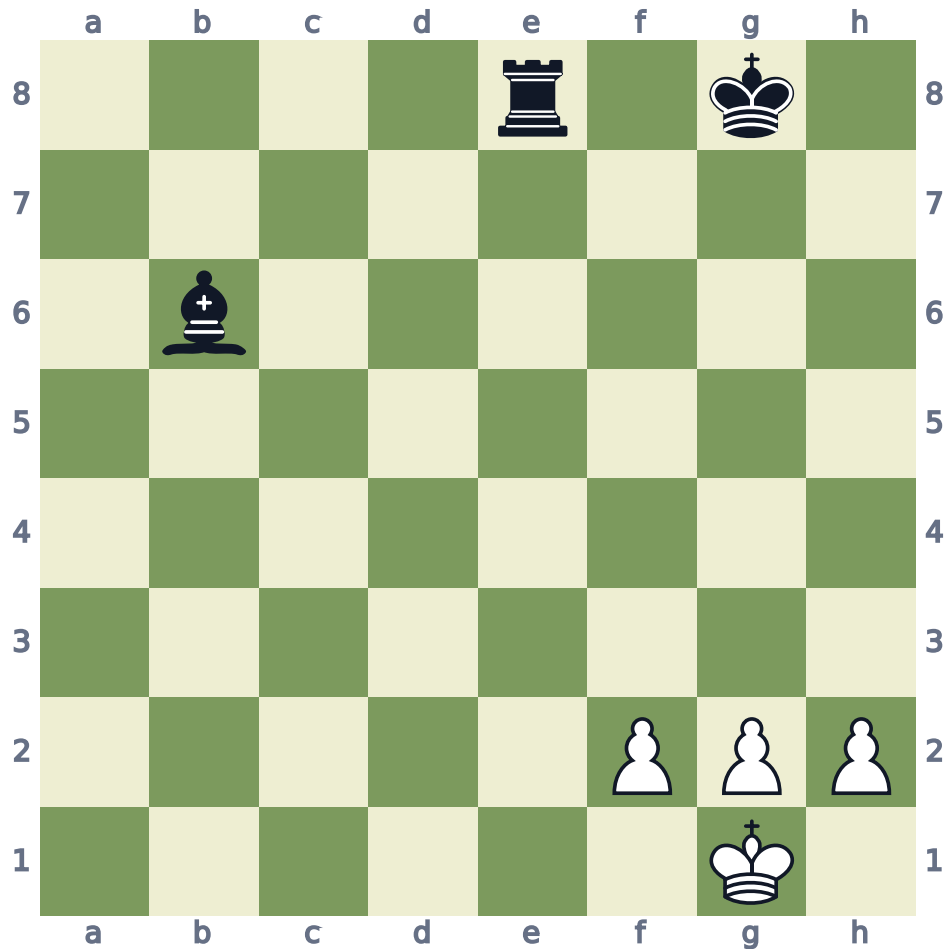
White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY**Foundation mate****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 06 OF 32

Rook-and-bishop back rank - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

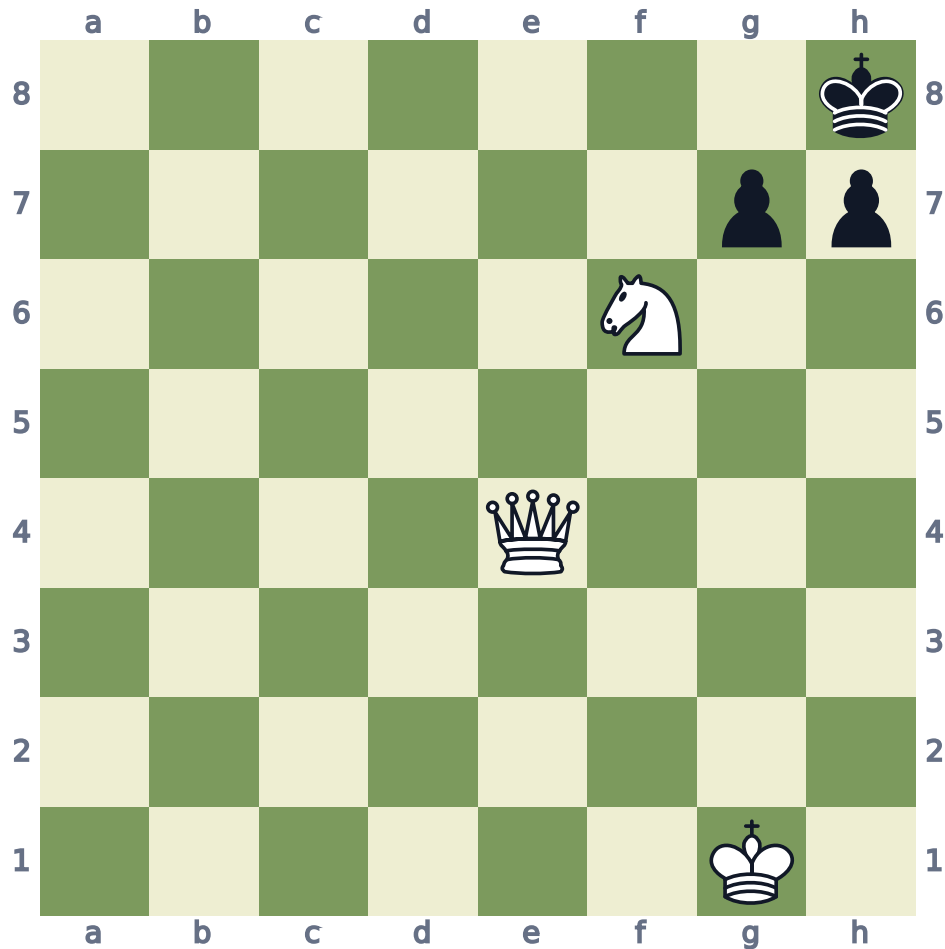
Foundation mate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 07 OF 32

Queen-and-knight mate



YOUR TASK

White to move. Find checkmate in one and name every escape square that is controlled or occupied.

DIFFICULTY

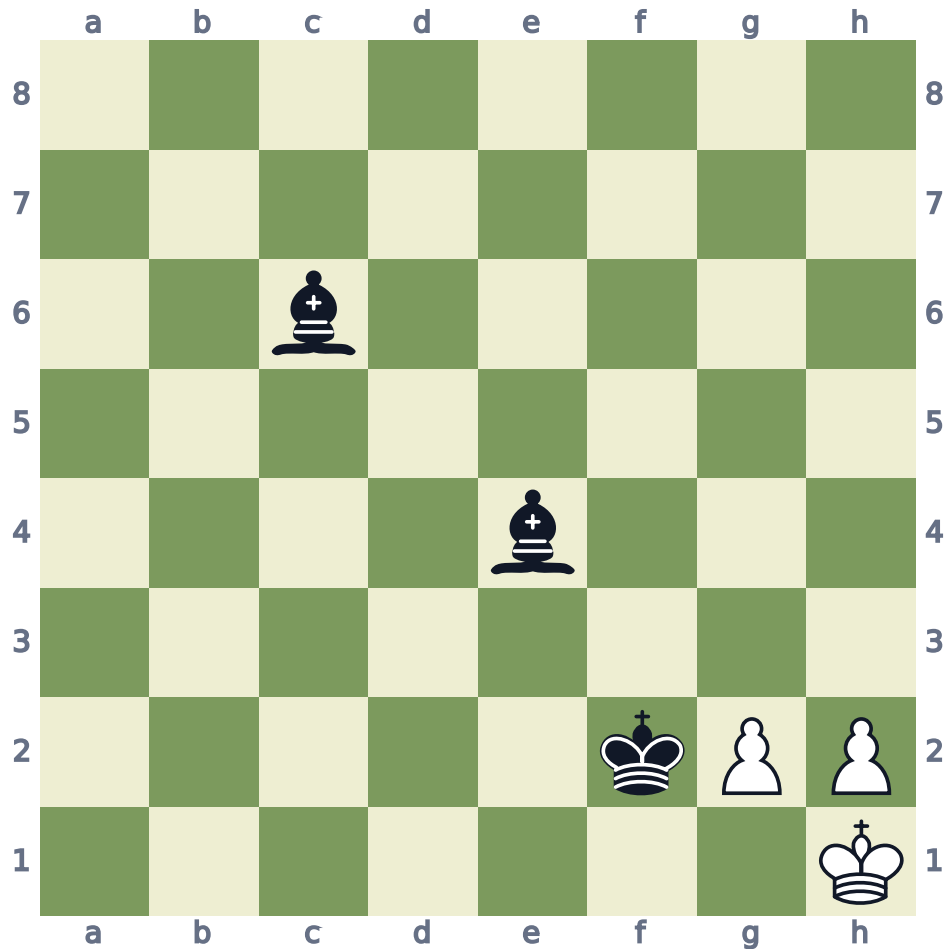
Foundation mate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 08 OF 32

Double-bishop mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Find checkmate in one. Explain the same geometry from the opposite orientation.

DIFFICULTY

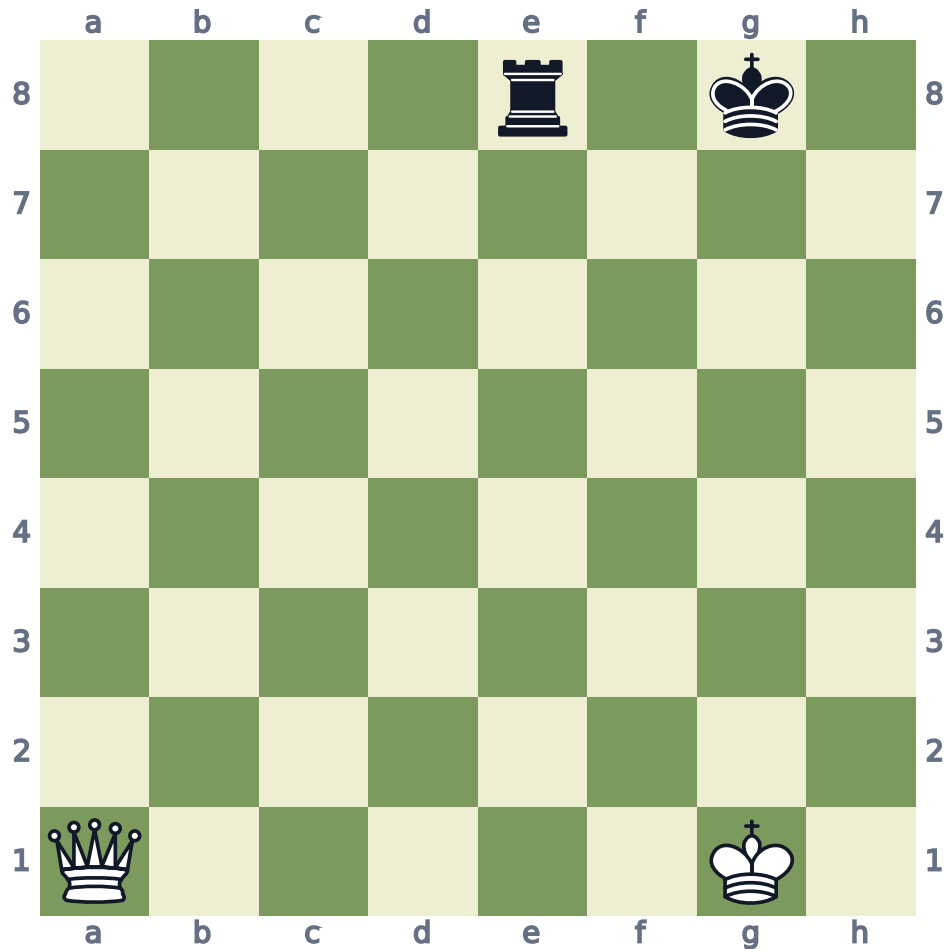
Foundation mate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 09 OF 32

Rook skewer - reverse view



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

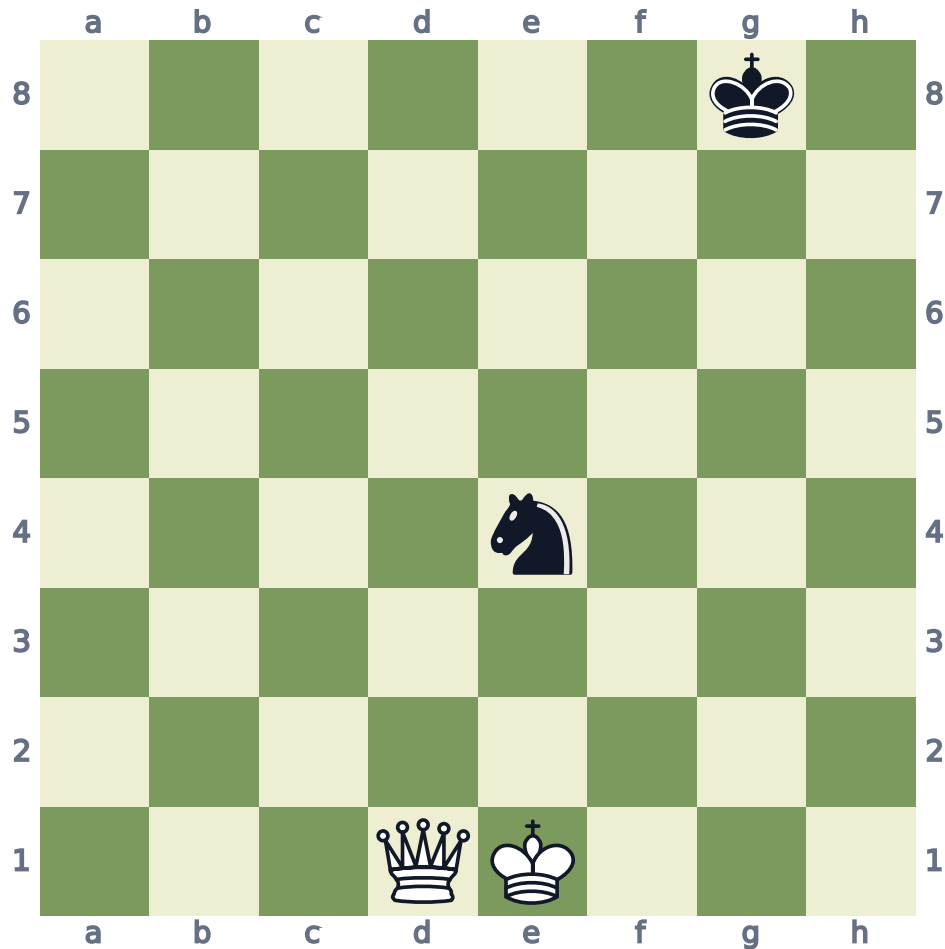
Developing

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 10 OF 32

Knight double attack - reverse view



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

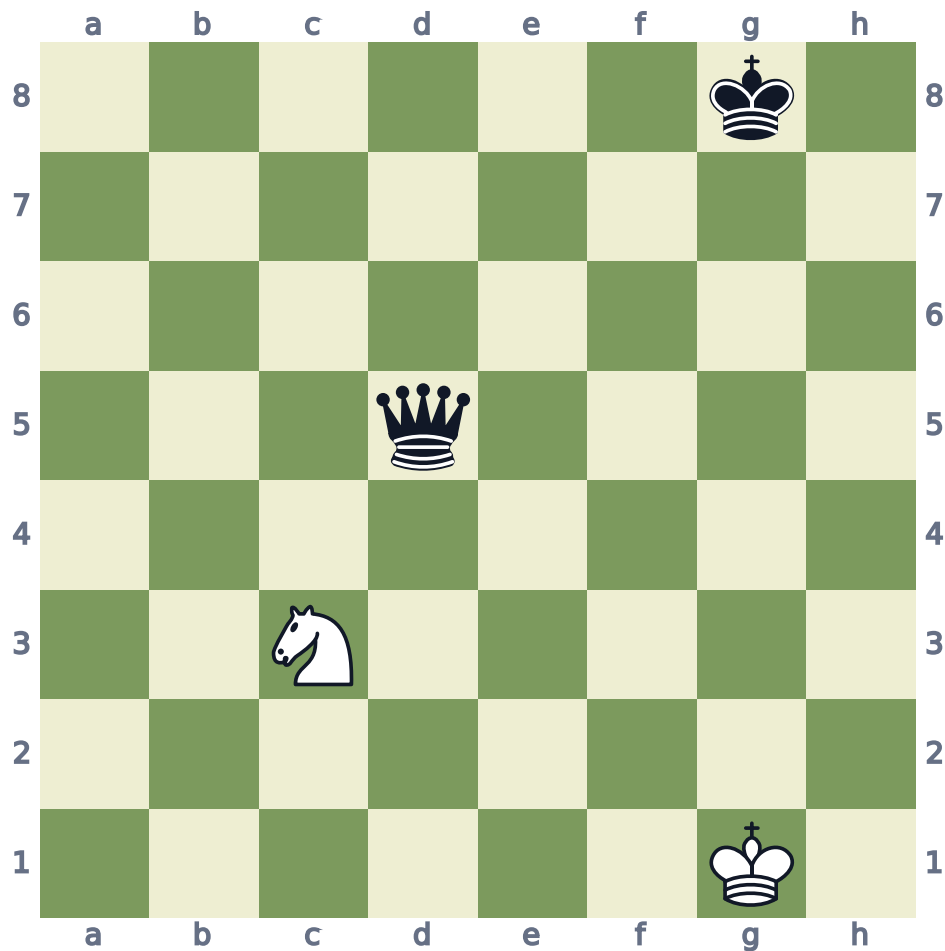
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 11 OF 32

Loose queen

**YOUR TASK**

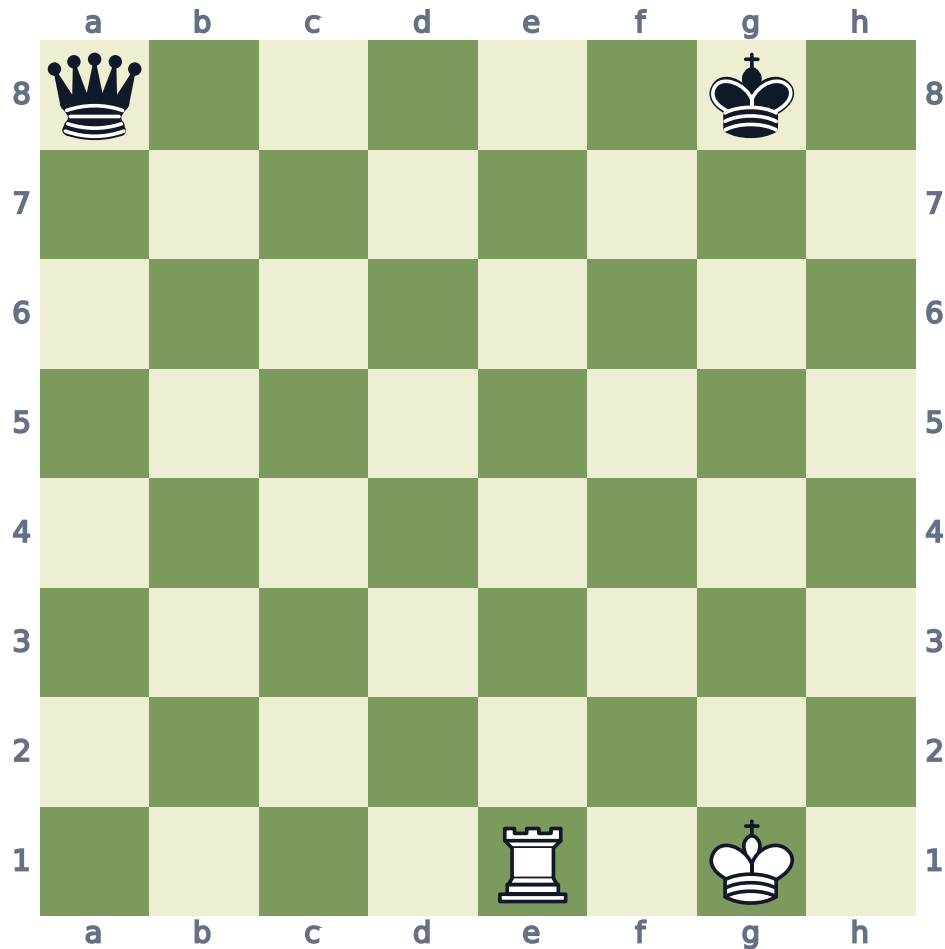
Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY**Intermediate****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 12 OF 32

Rook skewer



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

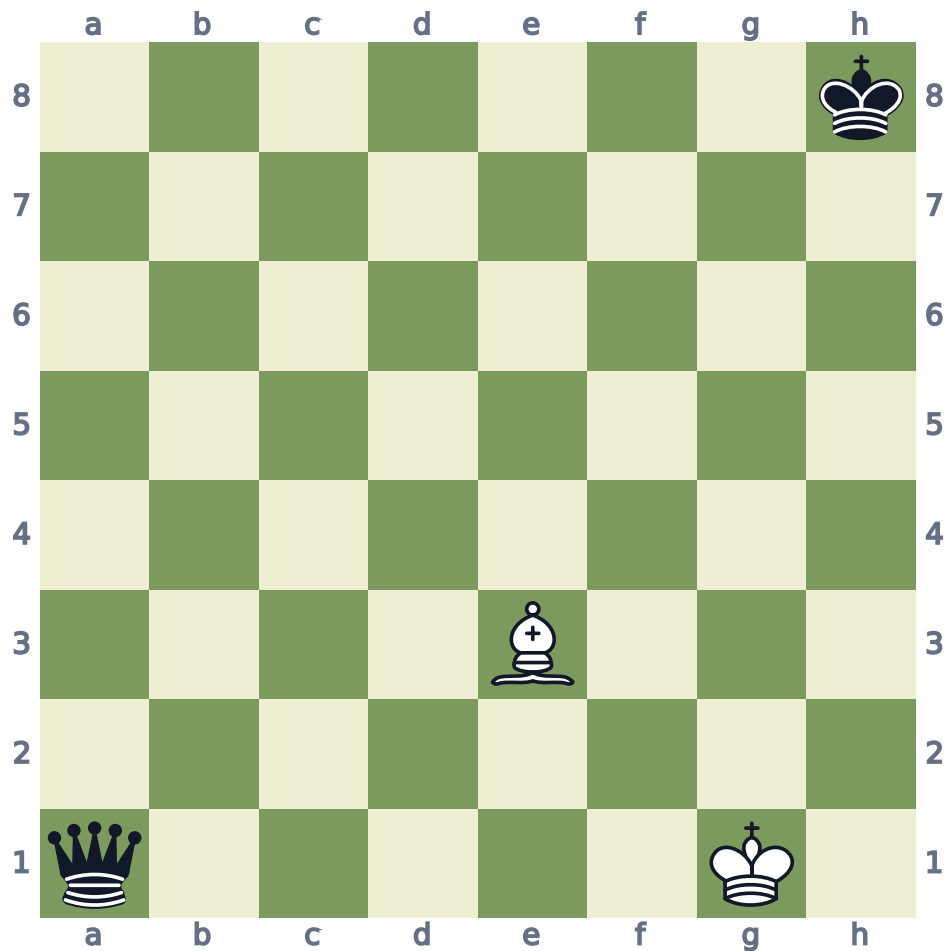
Developing

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 13 OF 32

Bishop skewer

**YOUR TASK**

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

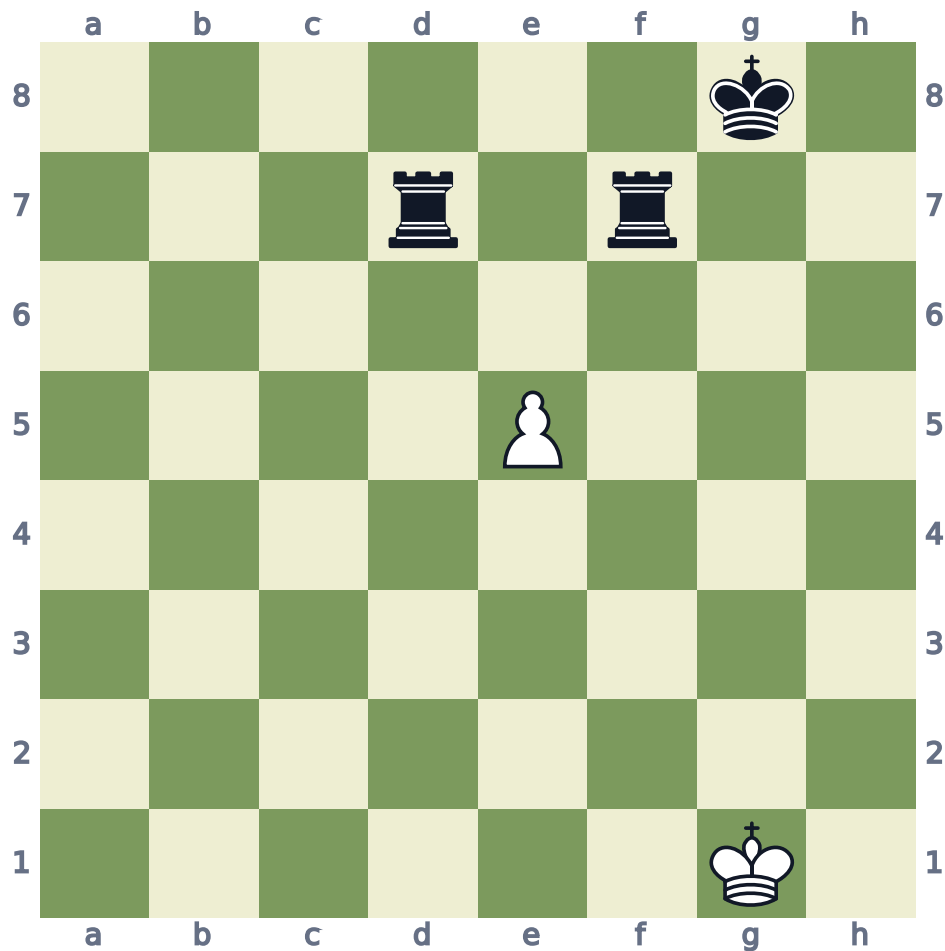
Intermediate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 14 OF 32

Pawn fork

**YOUR TASK**

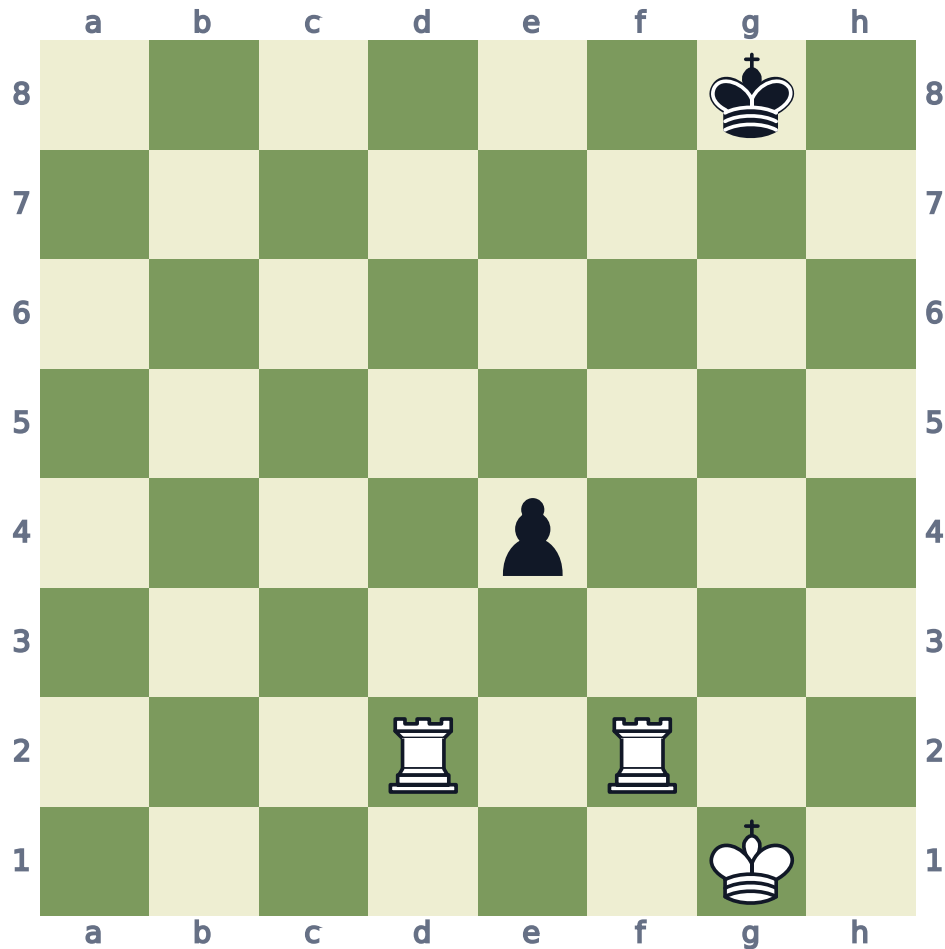
Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY**Developing****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 15 OF 32

Pawn fork - reverse view



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

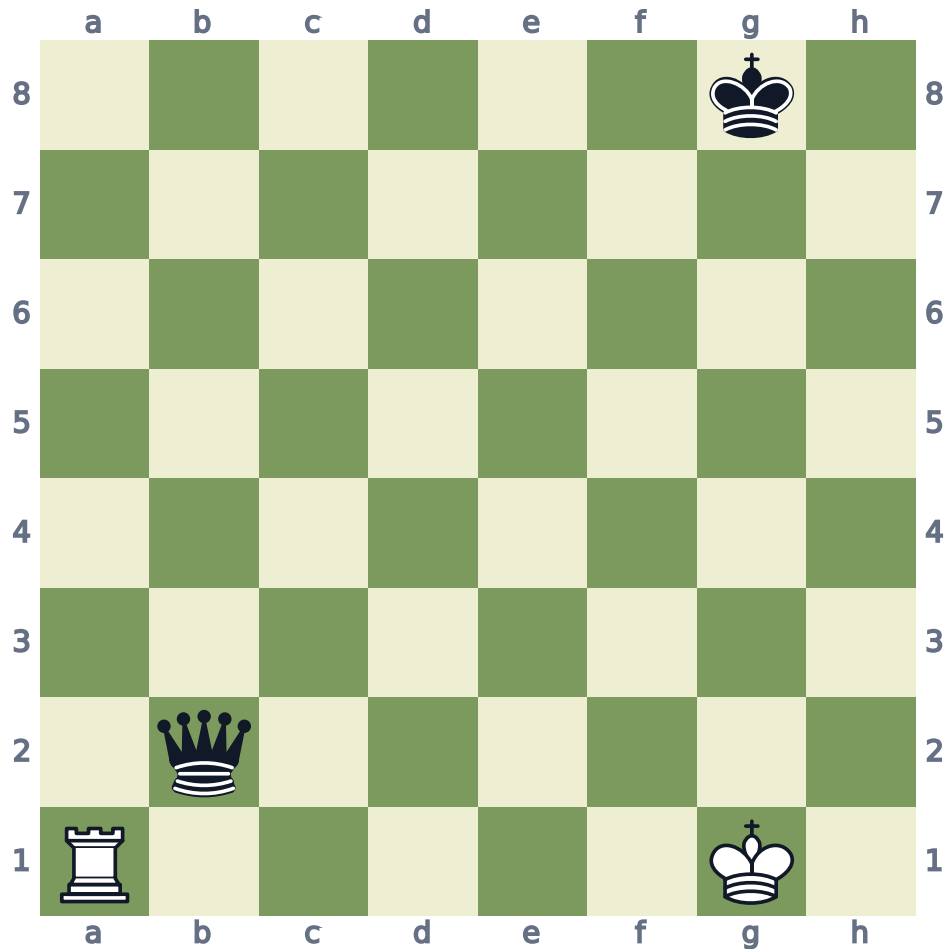
Developing

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 16 OF 32

Capture with check - reverse view

**YOUR TASK**

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

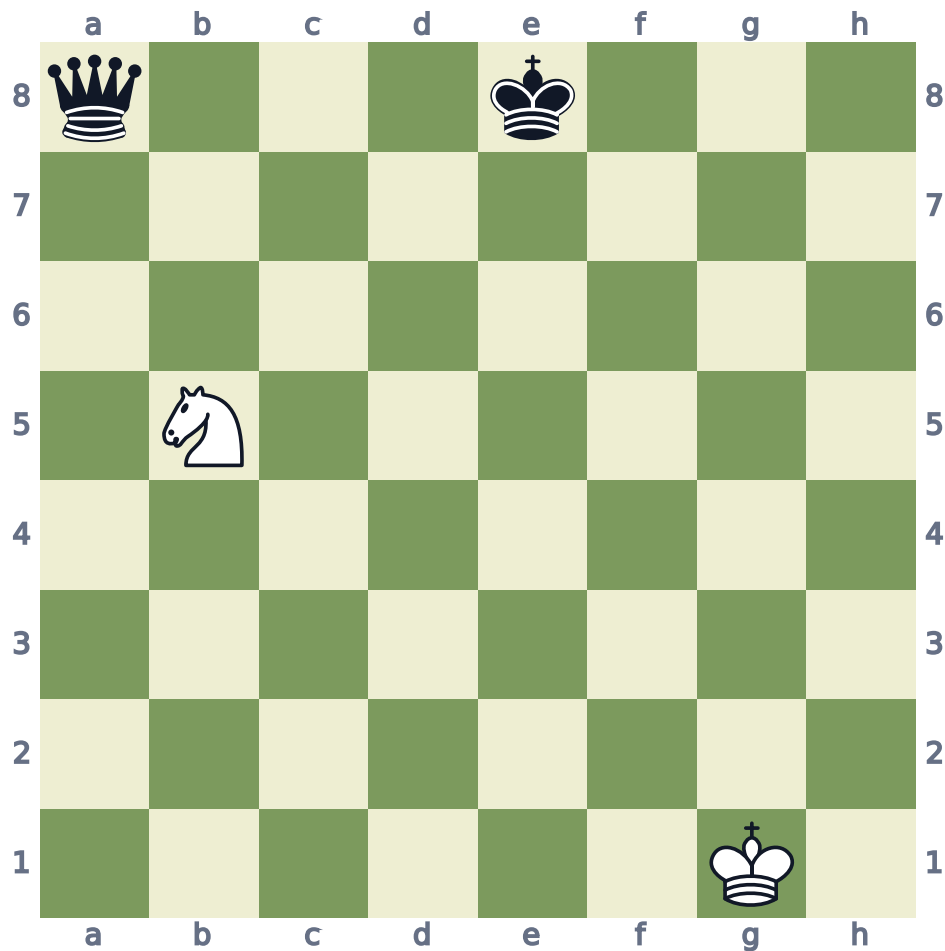
Intermediate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 17 OF 32

Royal fork

**YOUR TASK**

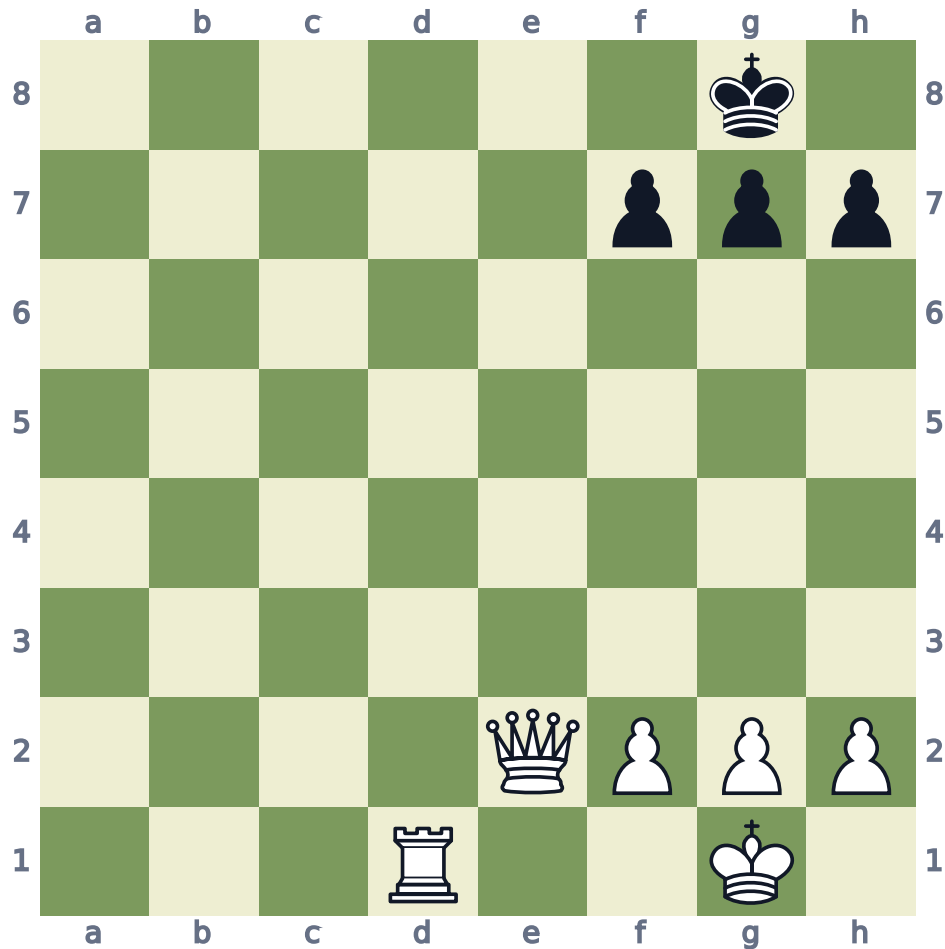
Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY**Foundation****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 18 OF 32

Back-rank geometry



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

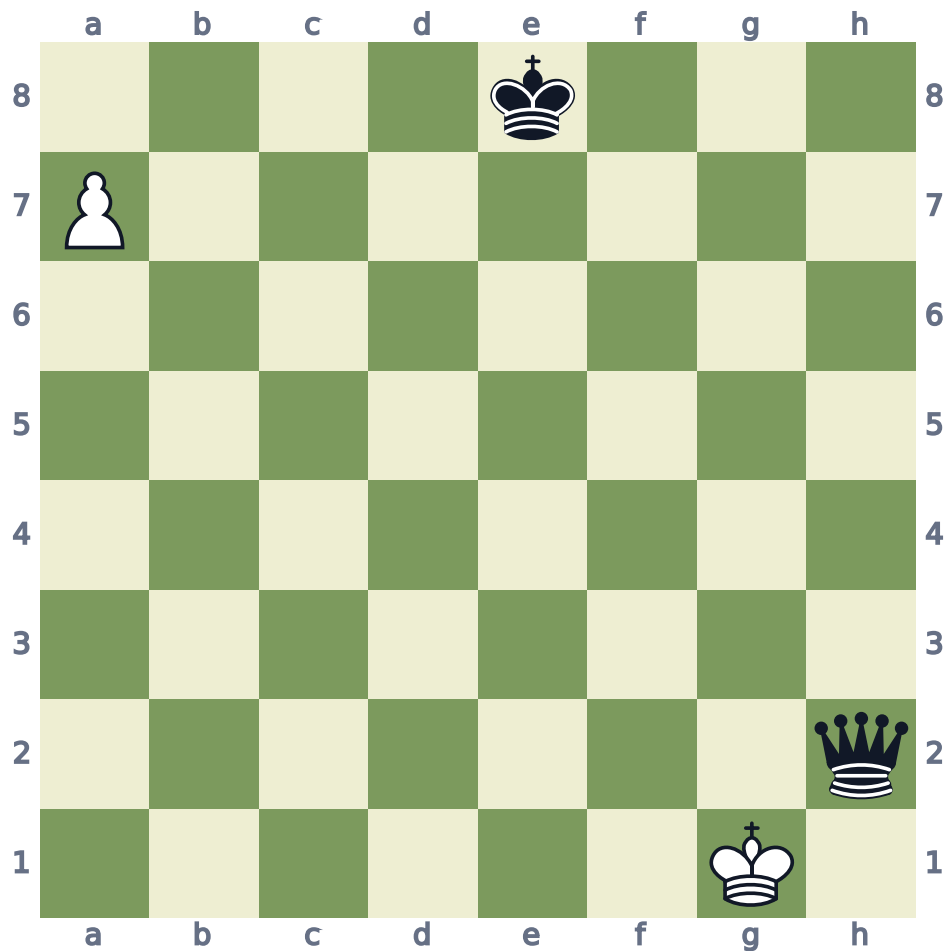
Mixed

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 19 OF 32

Promotion tactic

**YOUR TASK**

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

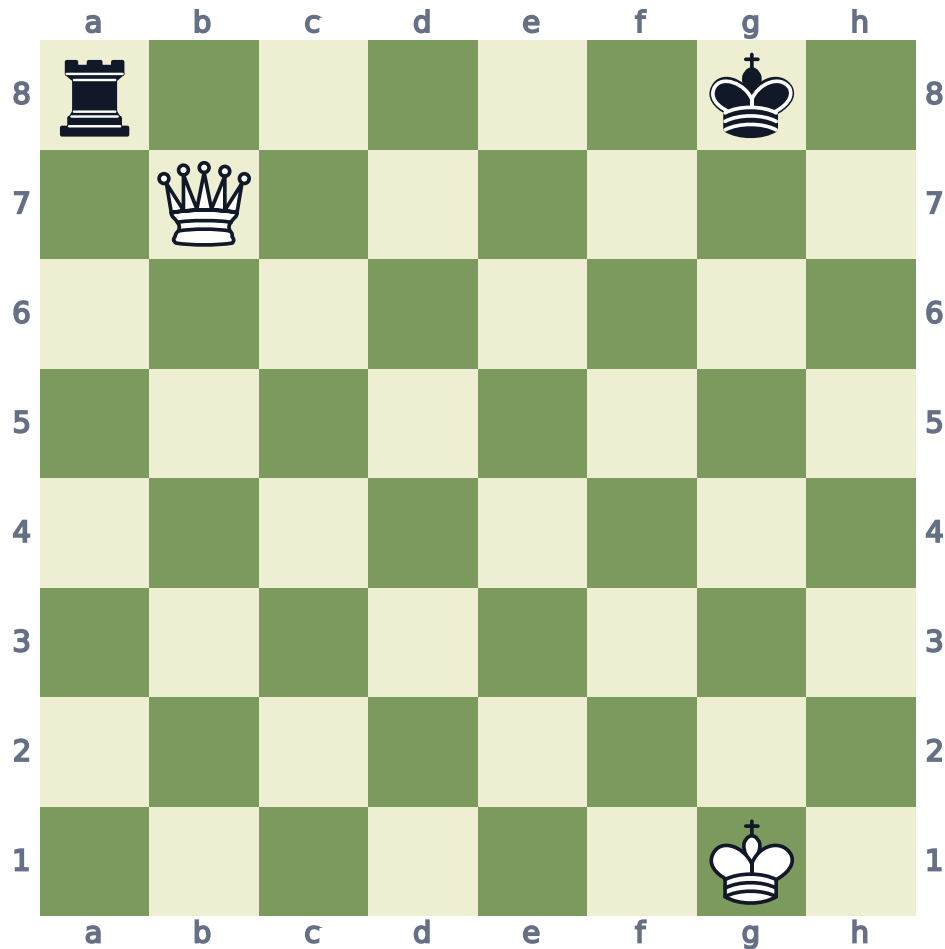
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 20 OF 32

Capture with check

**YOUR TASK**

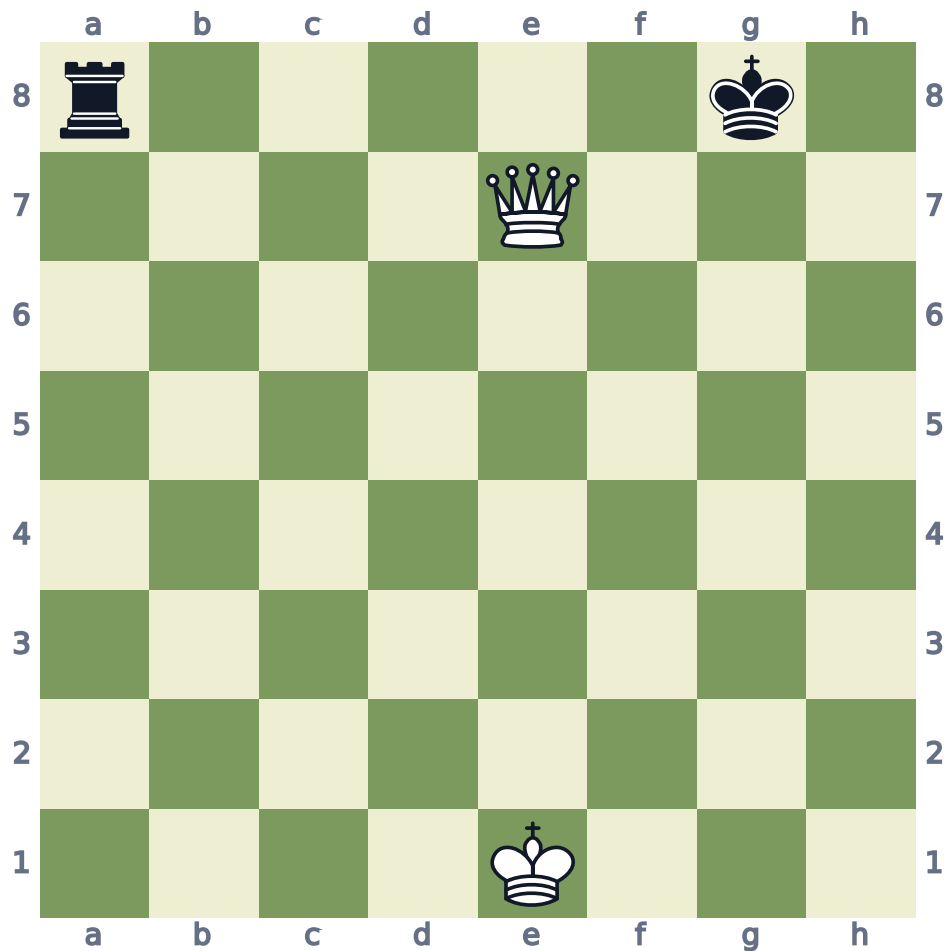
Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY**Intermediate****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 21 OF 32

Rook double attack - reverse view



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

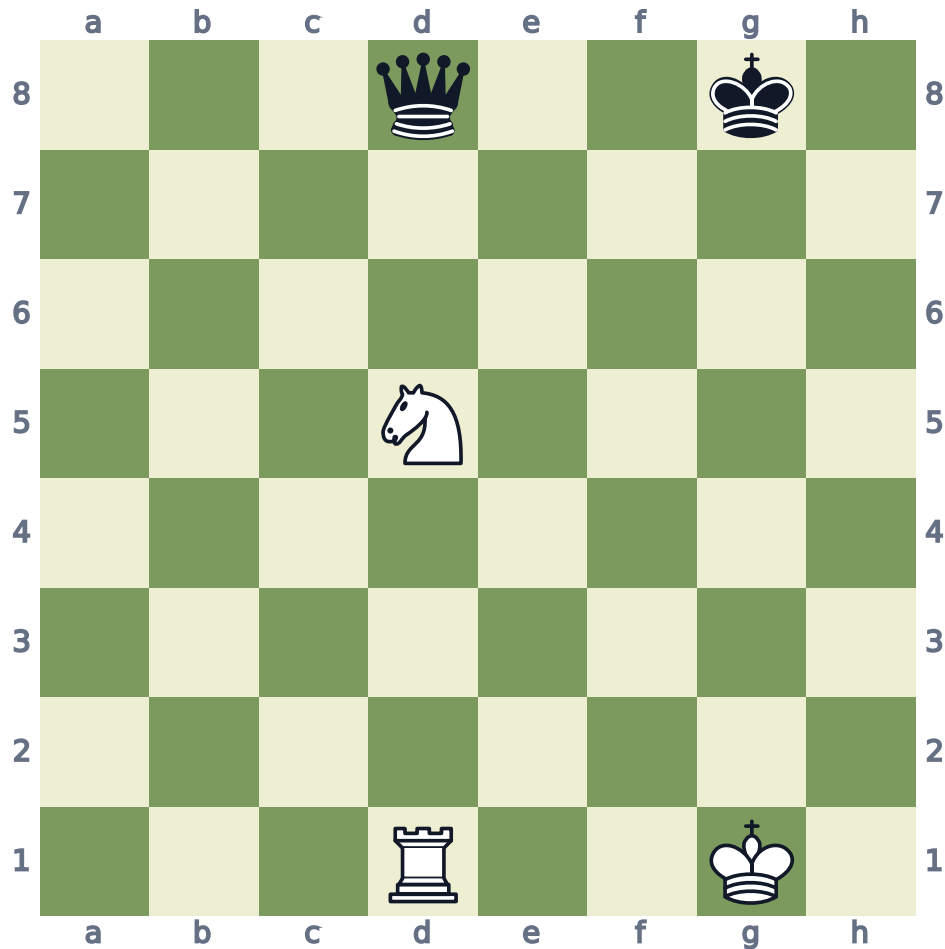
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 22 OF 32

Discovered attack



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

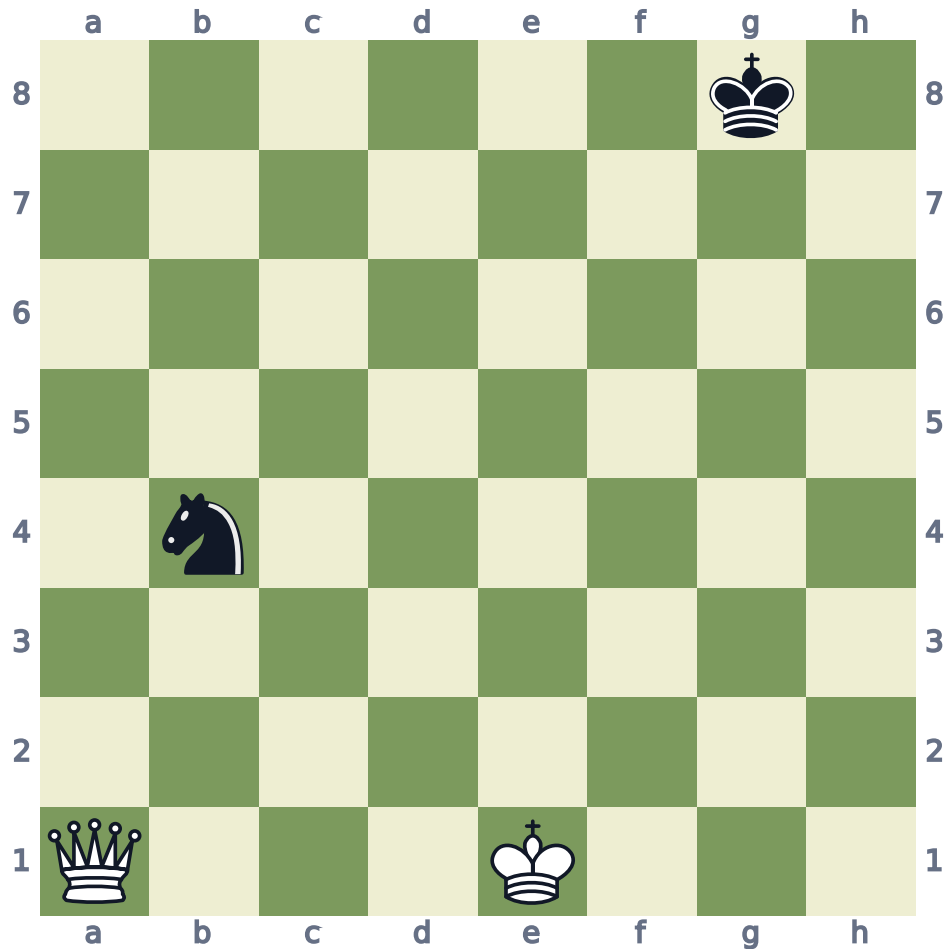
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 23 OF 32

Royal fork - reverse view



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

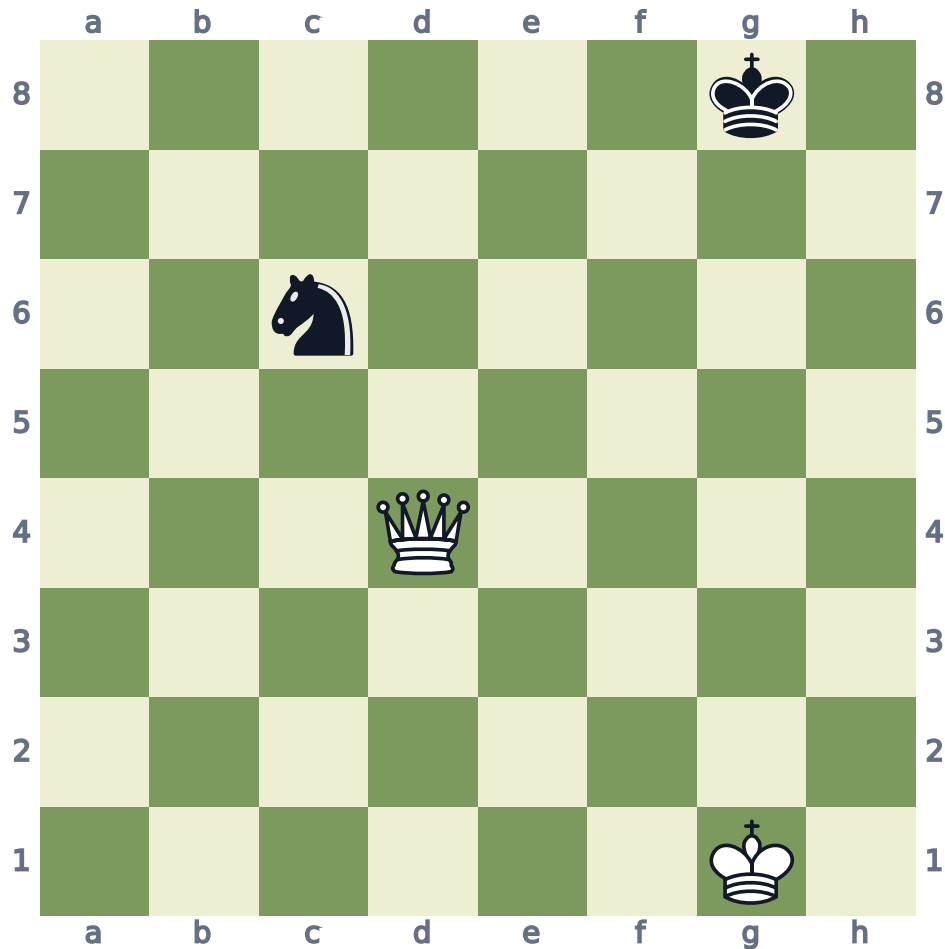
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 24 OF 32

Loose queen - reverse view

**YOUR TASK**

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

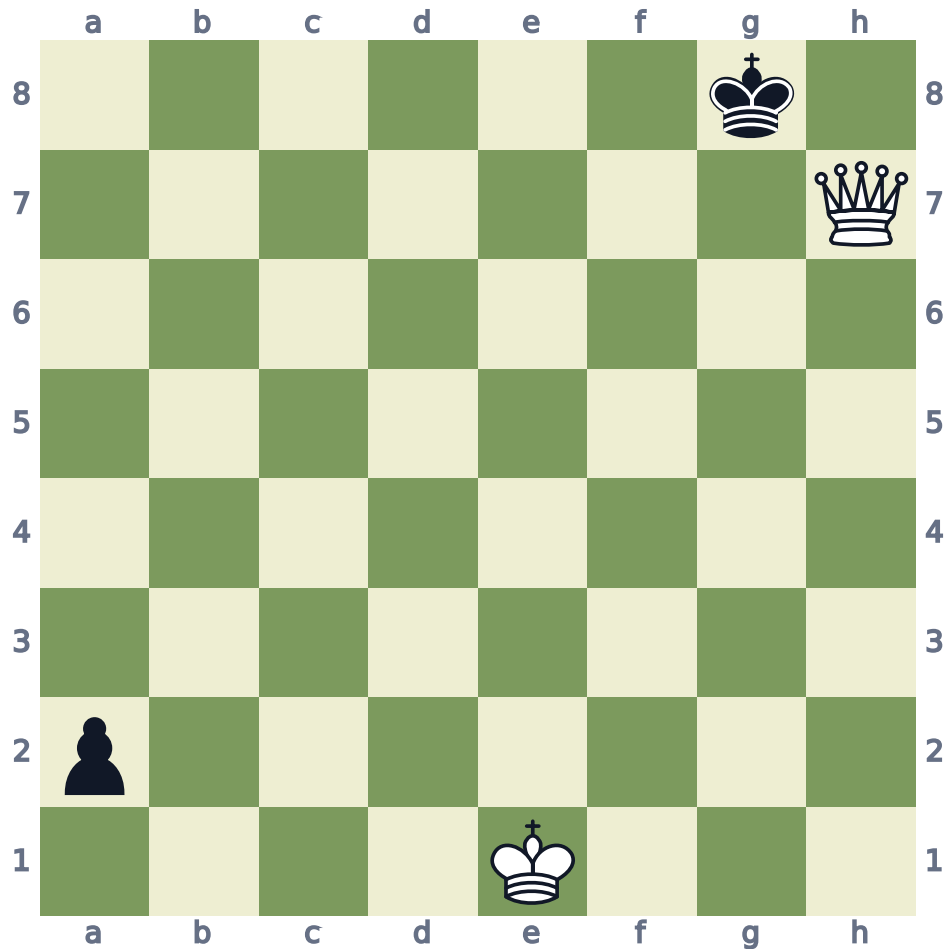
Intermediate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 25 OF 32

Promotion tactic - reverse view

**YOUR TASK**

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

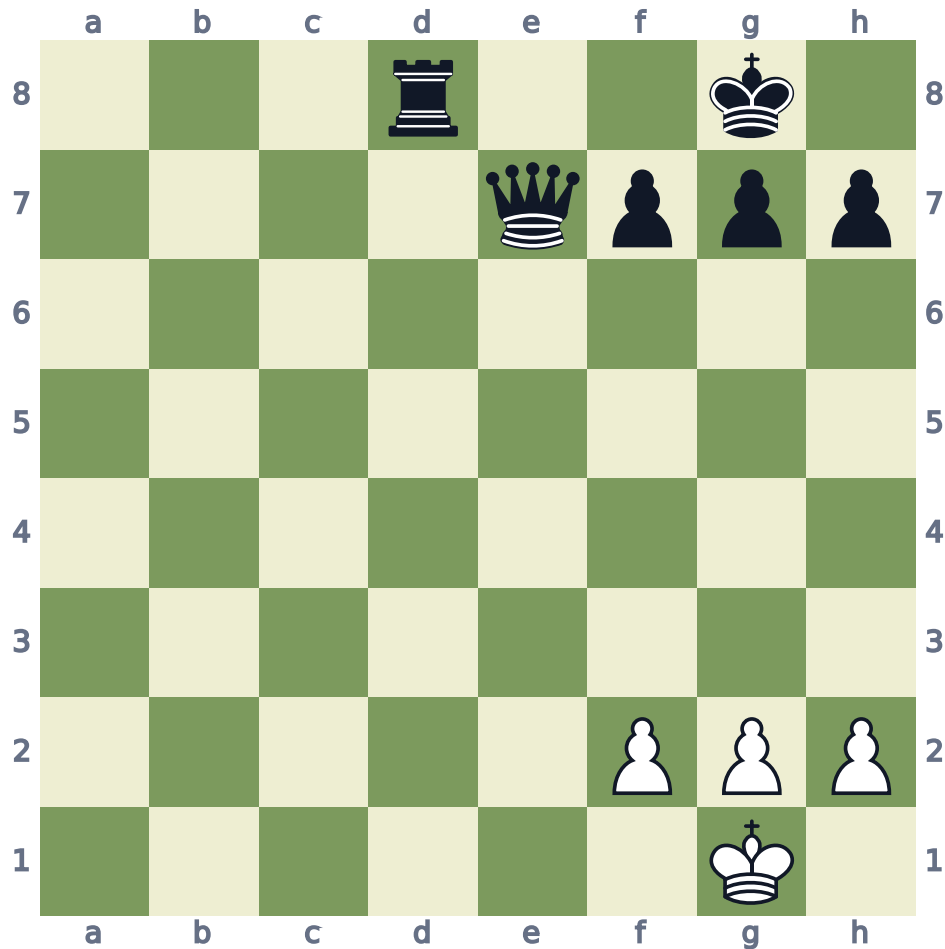
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 26 OF 32

Back-rank geometry - reverse view



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

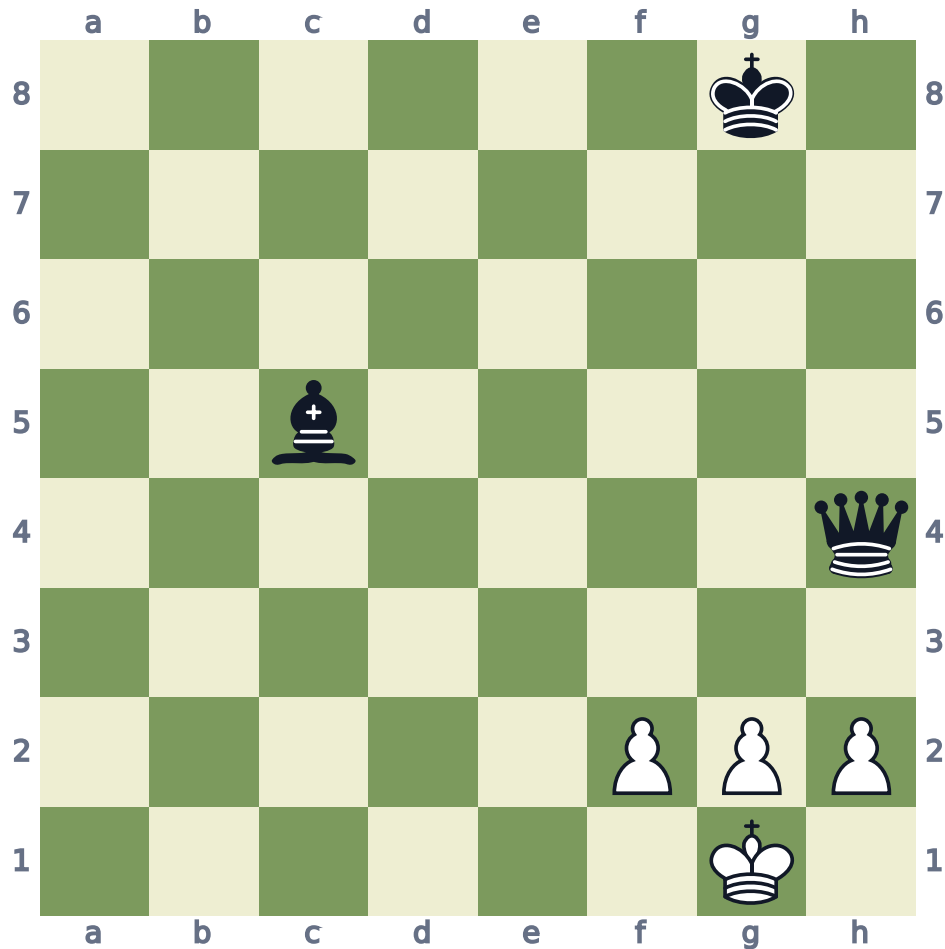
Mixed

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 27 OF 32

Removing the guard - reverse view



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

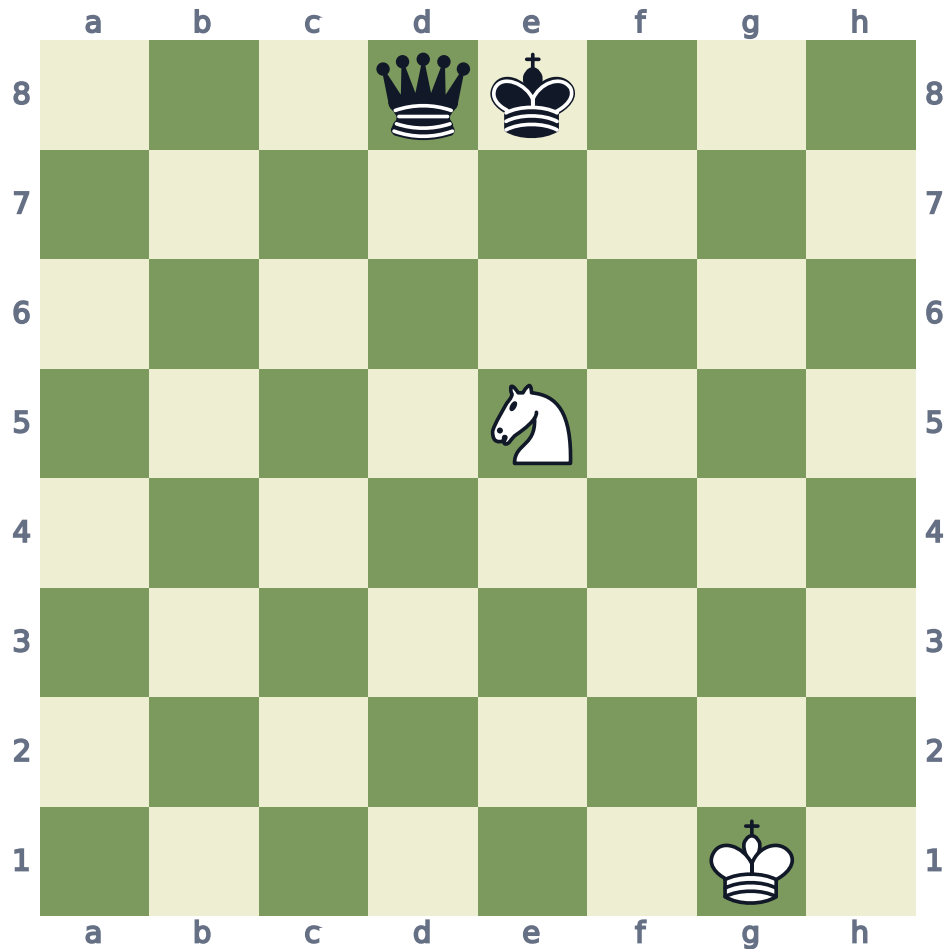
Mixed

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 28 OF 32

Knight double attack



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

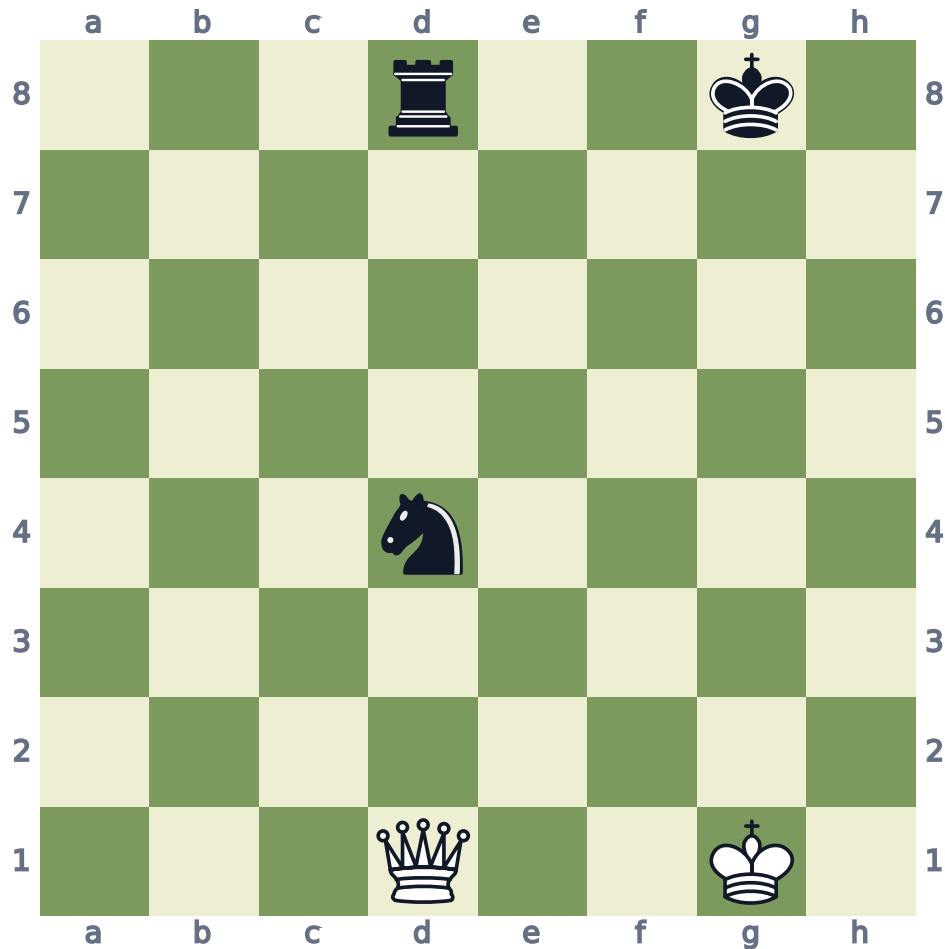
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 29 OF 32

Discovered attack - reverse view



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

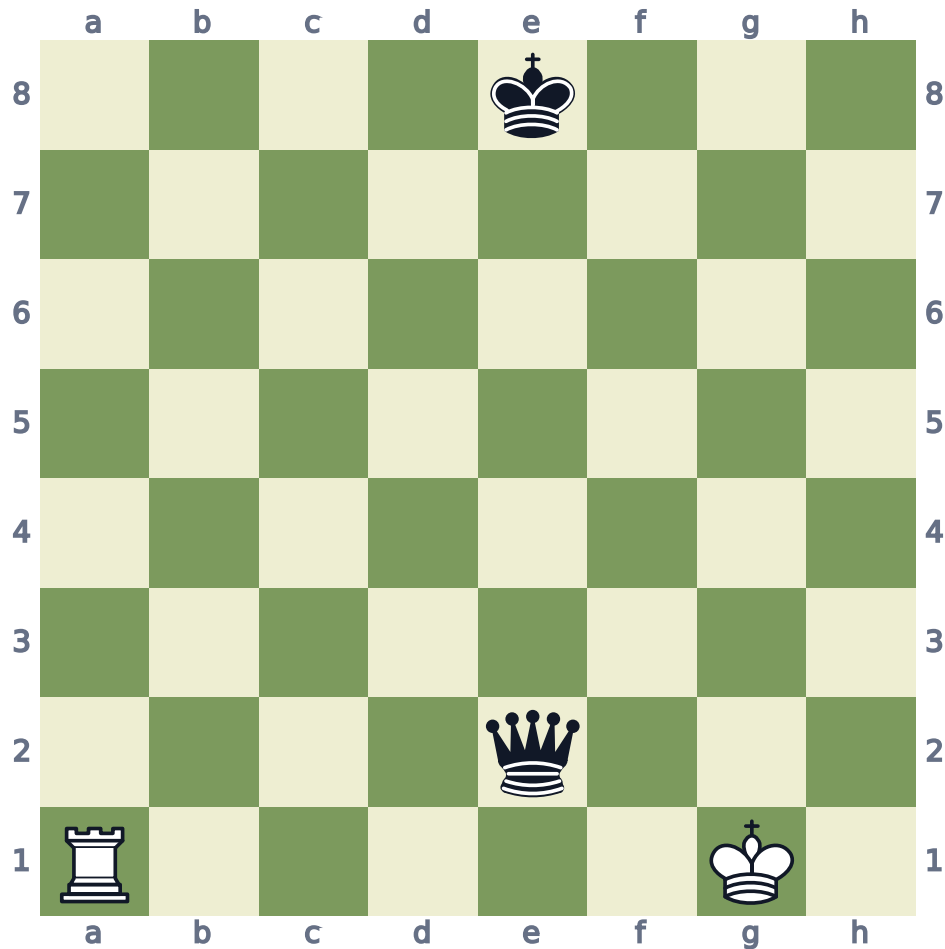
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 30 OF 32

Rook double attack



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

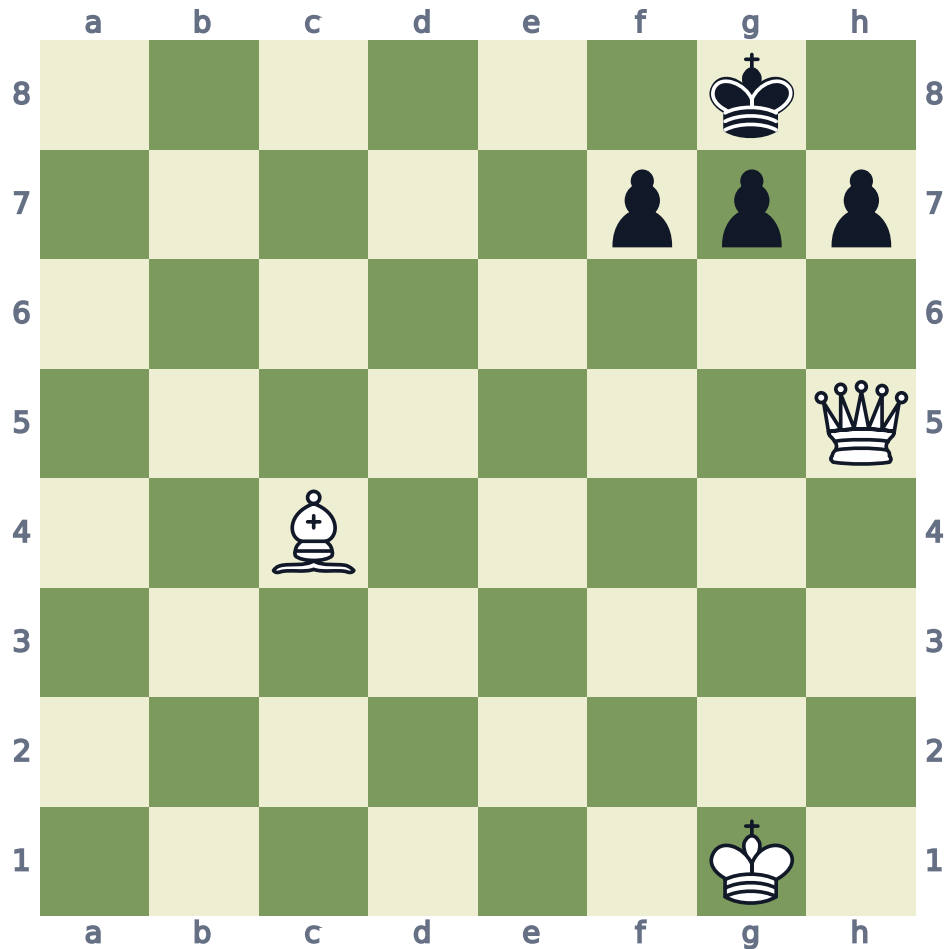
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 31 OF 32

Removing the guard



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

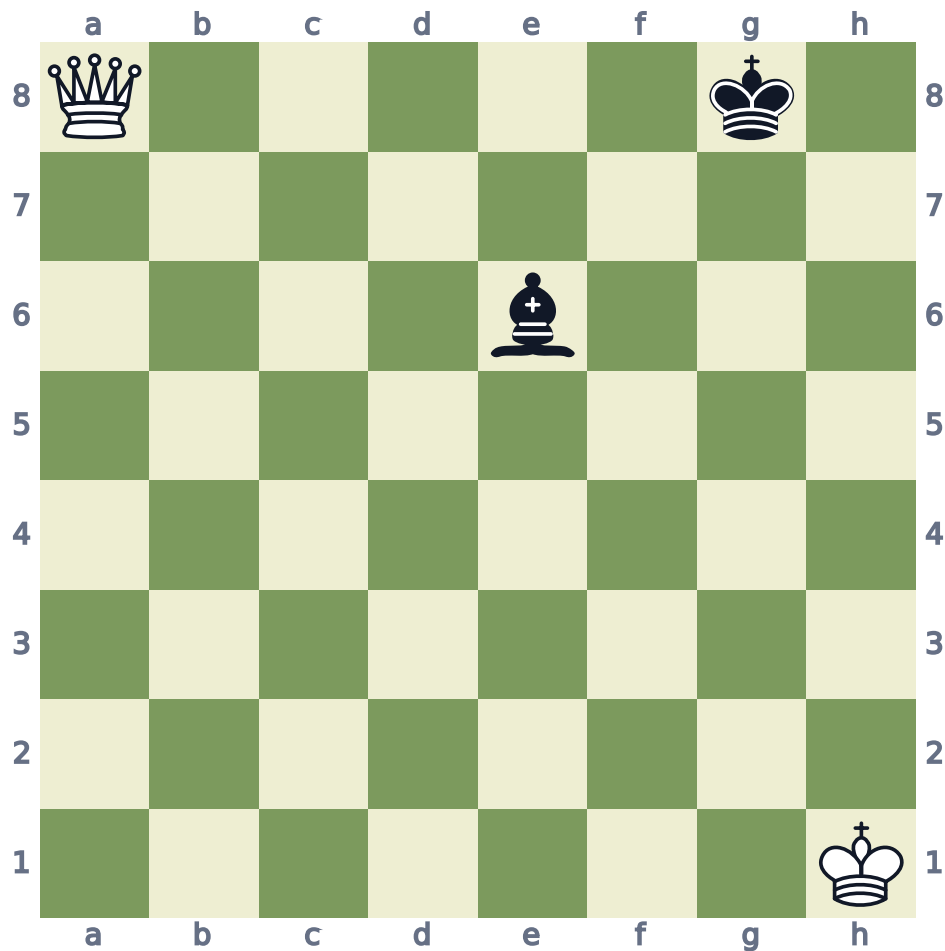
Mixed

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 32 OF 32

Bishop skewer - reverse view



YOUR TASK

Find the strongest move. Calculate the opponent's best resistance and evaluate the endpoint before checking the solution.

DIFFICULTY

Intermediate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

ANSWER SECTION

Solutions begin on the next page

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not browse the solution pages casually. Return to each problem, reconstruct the position, and compare the entire decision process. If your move matches but your line omits the best defense, score it as incomplete.

ERROR LABELS

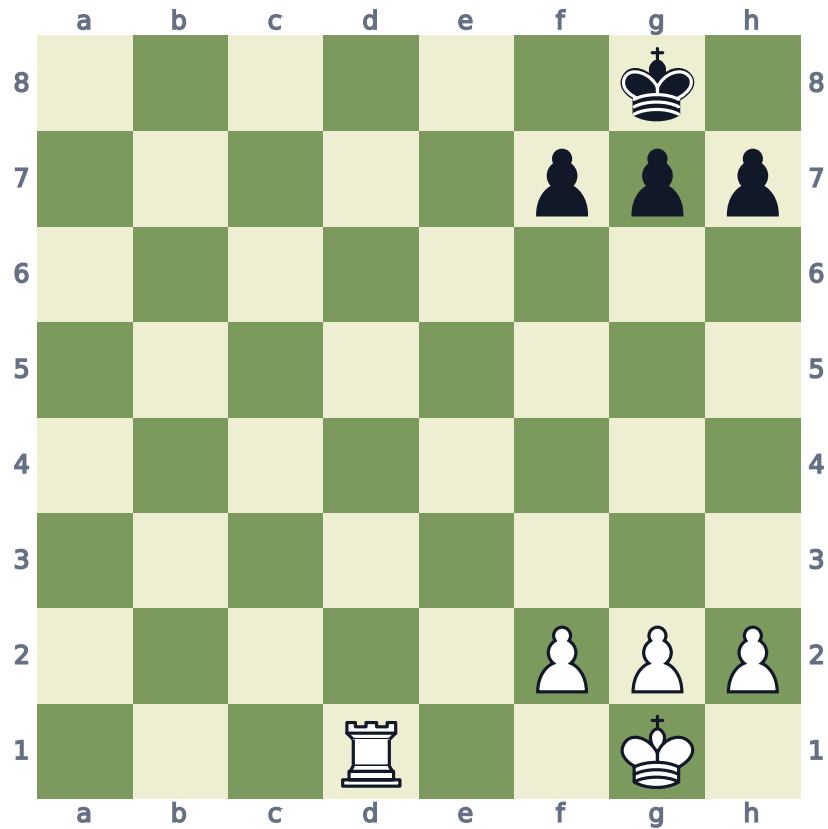
R = recognition error | C = candidate error | V = visualization error | D = missed defense | E = endpoint evaluation error | T = time-management error

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce one replacement question. Example: 'Before I calculate my attack, what countercheck does the opponent have?' Use that question in the next five slow games.

SOLUTION 01 OF 32

Back-rank mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Rd8#

WHY IT WORKS

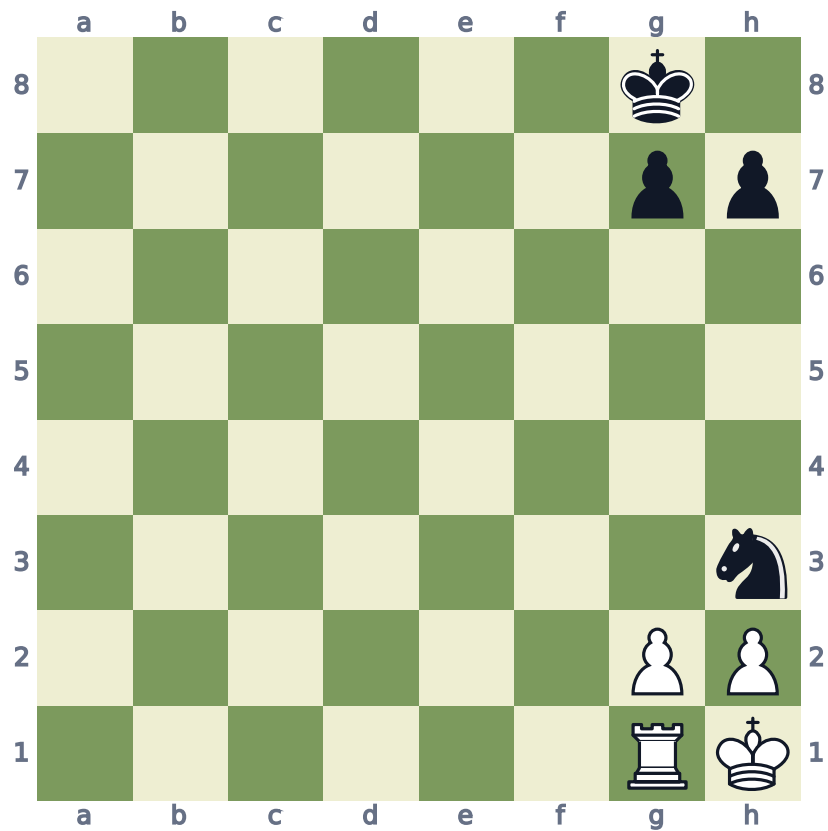
The rook enters the back rank while the king's own pawns remove every flight square.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 02 OF 32

Smothered mate - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

Nf2#

WHY IT WORKS

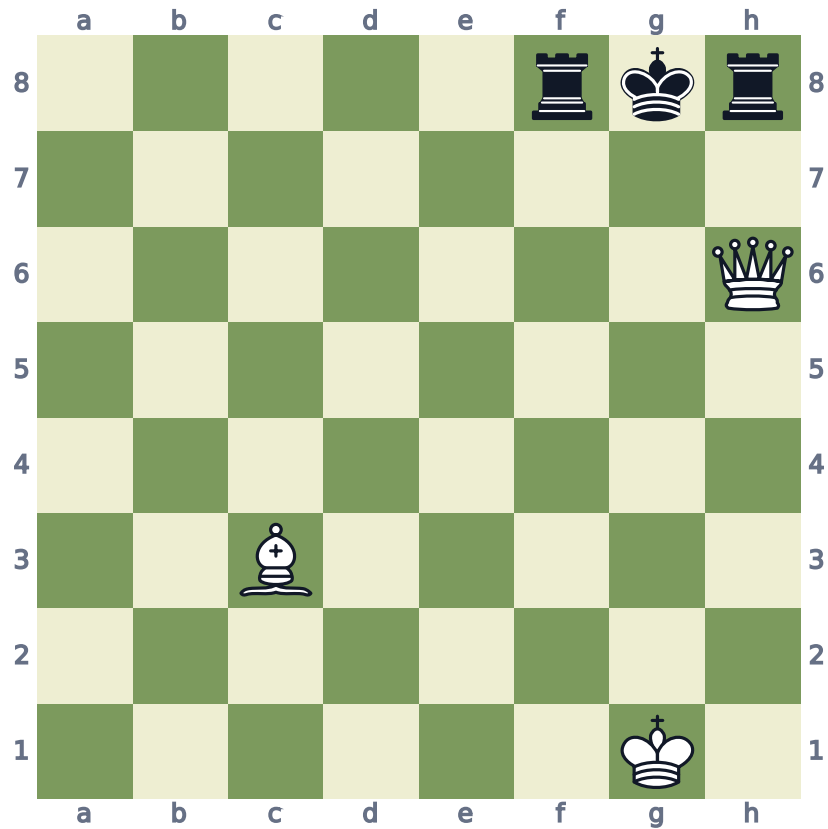
The knight checks a king completely enclosed by its own rook and pawns.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 03 OF 32

Epaulette mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Qg7#

WHY IT WORKS

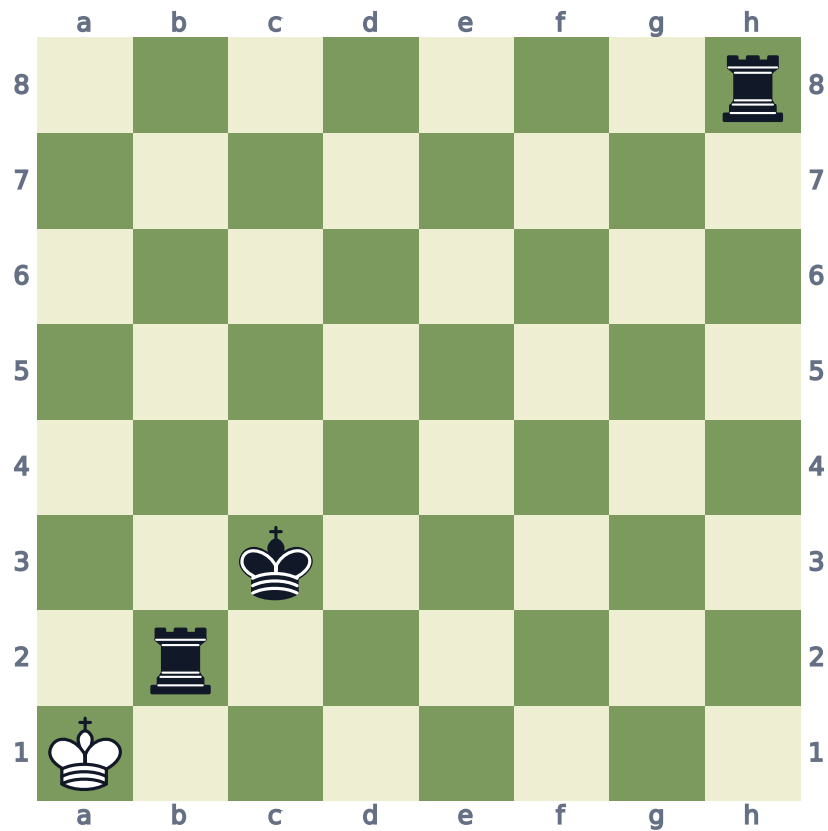
The king's own rooks form the epaulettes; the queen checks from close range and the bishop protects it.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 04 OF 32

Ladder mate - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

Rh1#

WHY IT WORKS

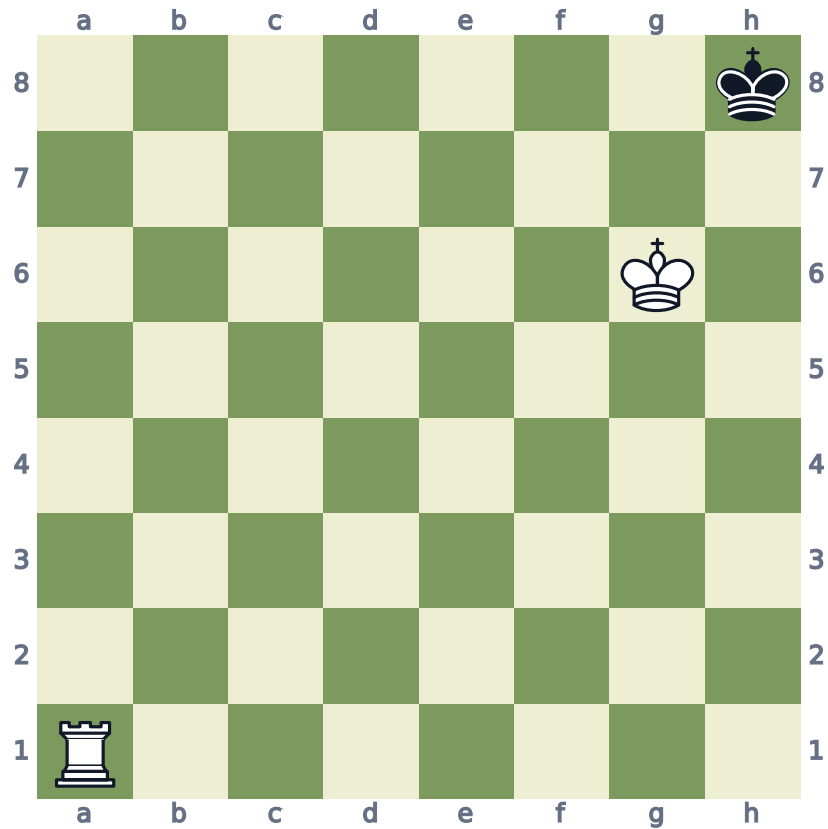
One rook gives the checking wall while the second rook seals the rank below it.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 05 OF 32

Rook box mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Ra8#

WHY IT WORKS

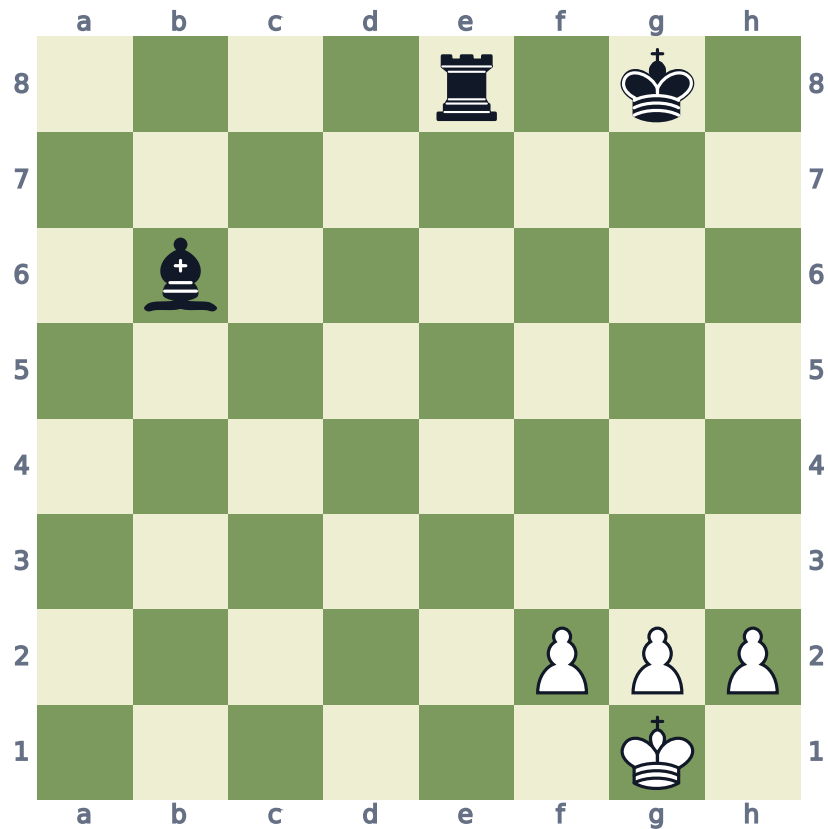
The rook checks across the back rank while the king closes both escape squares.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 06 OF 32

Rook-and-bishop back rank - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

Re1#

WHY IT WORKS

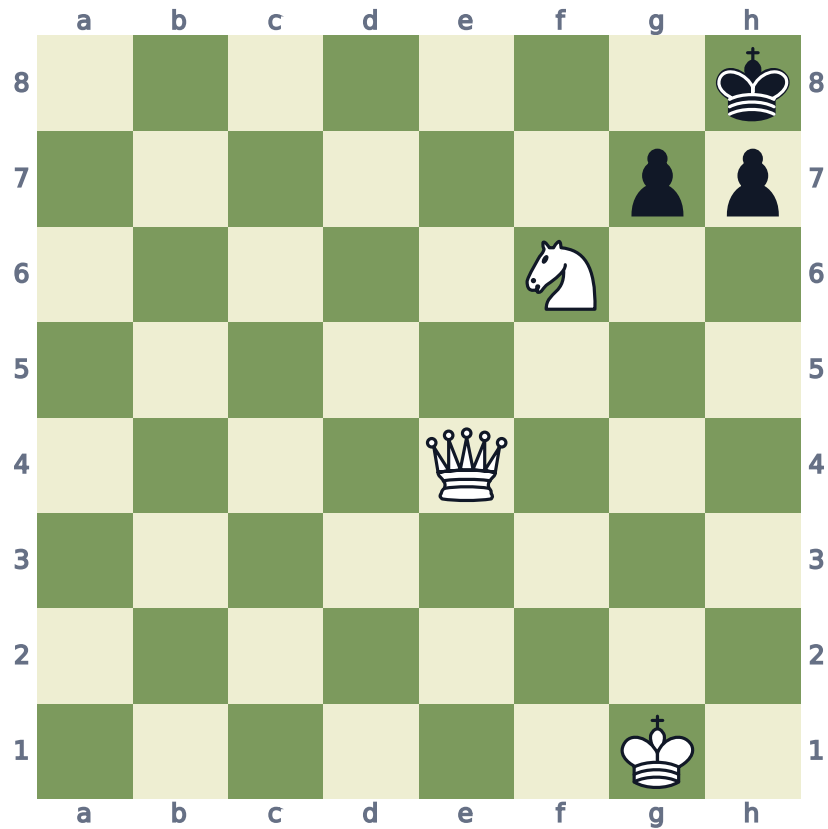
The rook controls the rank while the bishop covers the king's diagonal escape.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 07 OF 32

Queen-and-knight mate

**VERIFIED LINE**

Qxh7#

WHY IT WORKS

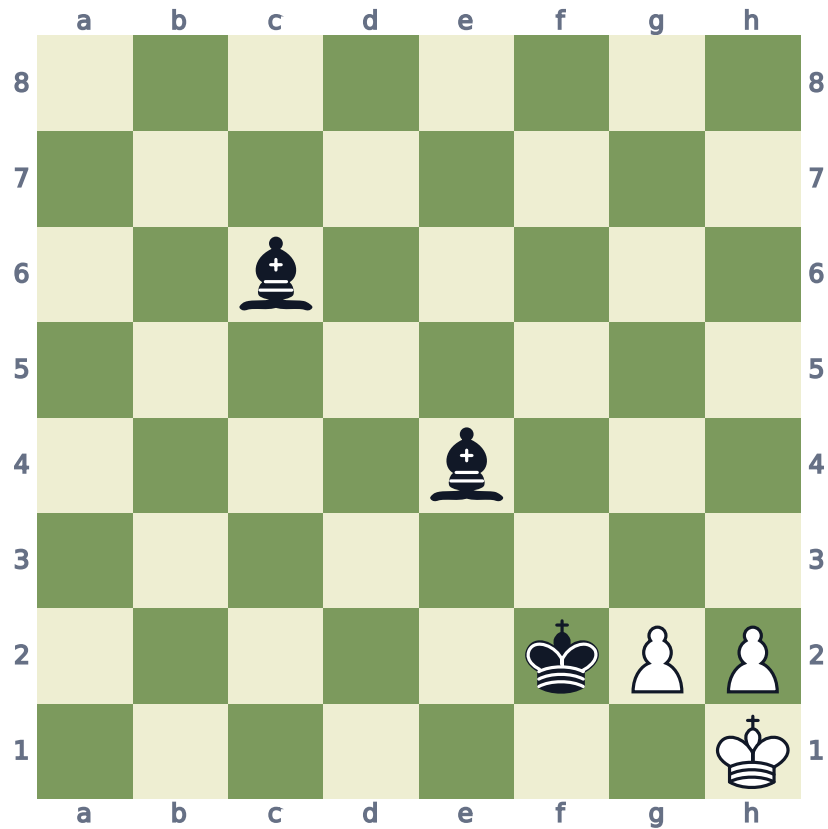
The knight protects the queen and covers the square the king most wants to use.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 08 OF 32

Double-bishop mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

Bxg2#

WHY IT WORKS

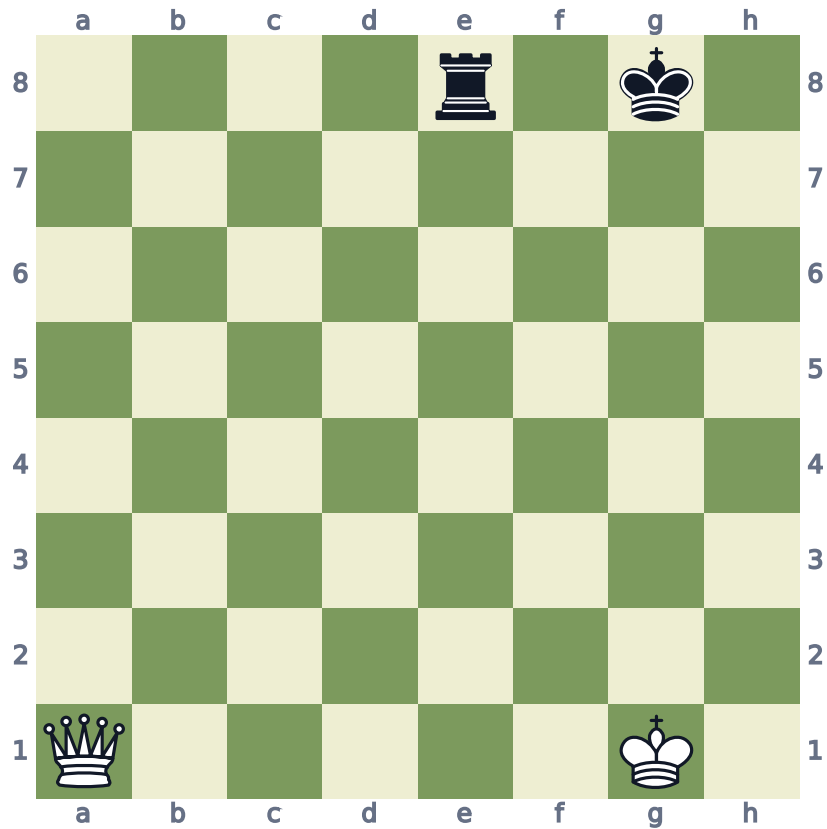
One bishop captures with check, the other protects it across the board, and the king closes g8.

SCORING

1 move, 2 geometry, 1 verbal explanation = 4 points Engine assessment: forced checkmate or exact construction.

SOLUTION 09 OF 32

Rook skewer - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kf7 Kh2 2. Ke7 Qb1 3. Rh8+ Kg2 4. Re8

WHY IT WORKS

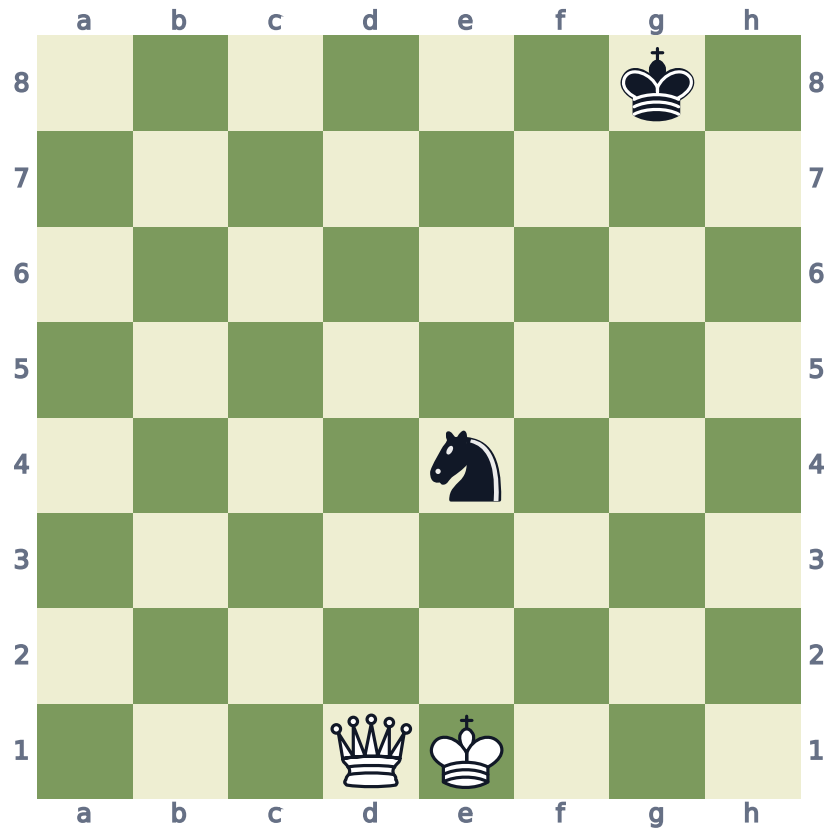
A forcing rook check exposes the queen behind the king. The second engine candidate scores -2.13 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.02.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -2.11 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 10 OF 32

Knight double attack - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nf6 Kf2 2. Kf7 Qb3+ 3. Ke7 Qa3+ 4. Kf7

WHY IT WORKS

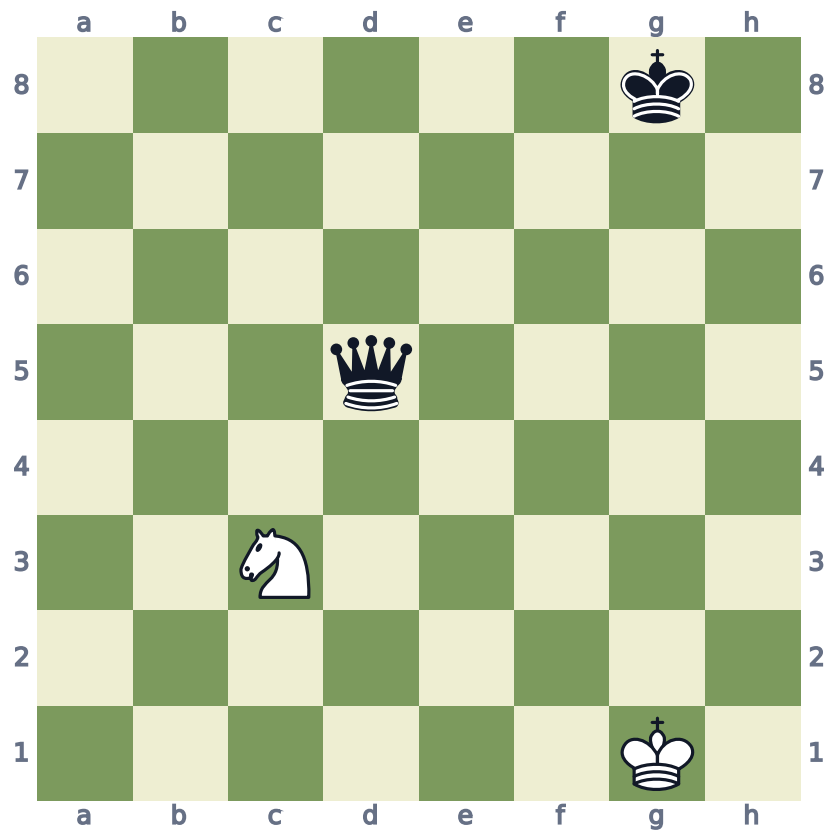
A knight move can attack king and queen simultaneously. The second engine candidate scores -5.29 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.09.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -5.20 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 11 OF 32

Loose queen



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nxd5 Kf7 2. Ne3 Ke6 3. Nf5 Kd7 4. Kg2

WHY IT WORKS

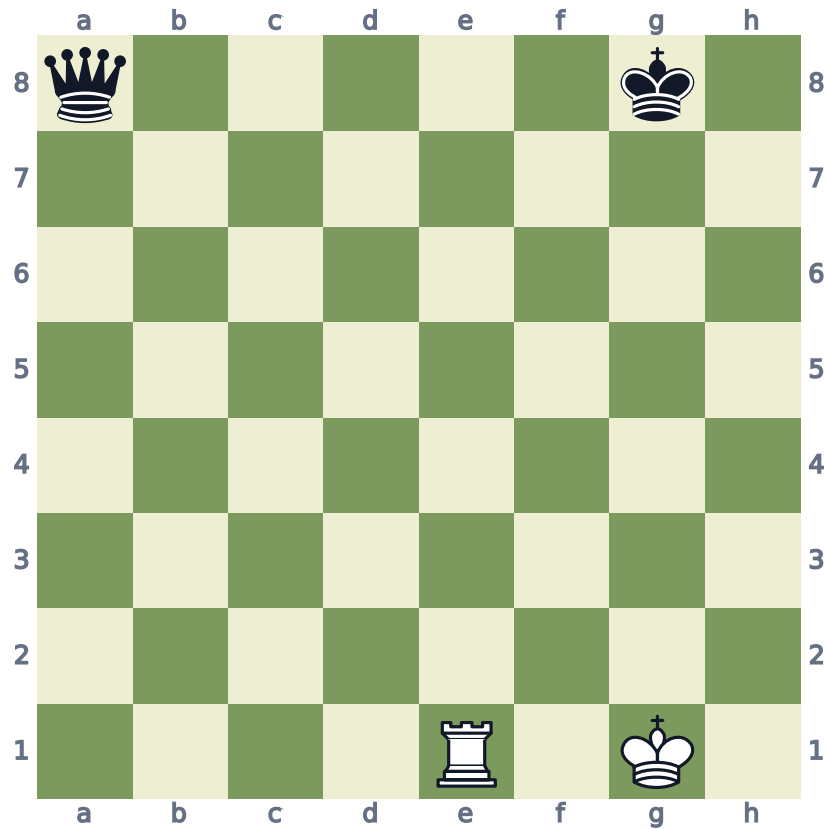
An undefended queen can be won by direct capture. The second engine candidate scores -5.48 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 5.37.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -0.11 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 12 OF 32

Rook skewer



VERIFIED LINE

1. Re3 Qa1+ 2. Kf2 Kf8 3. Re1 Qb2+ 4. Kf3 Qf6+ 5. Ke3

WHY IT WORKS

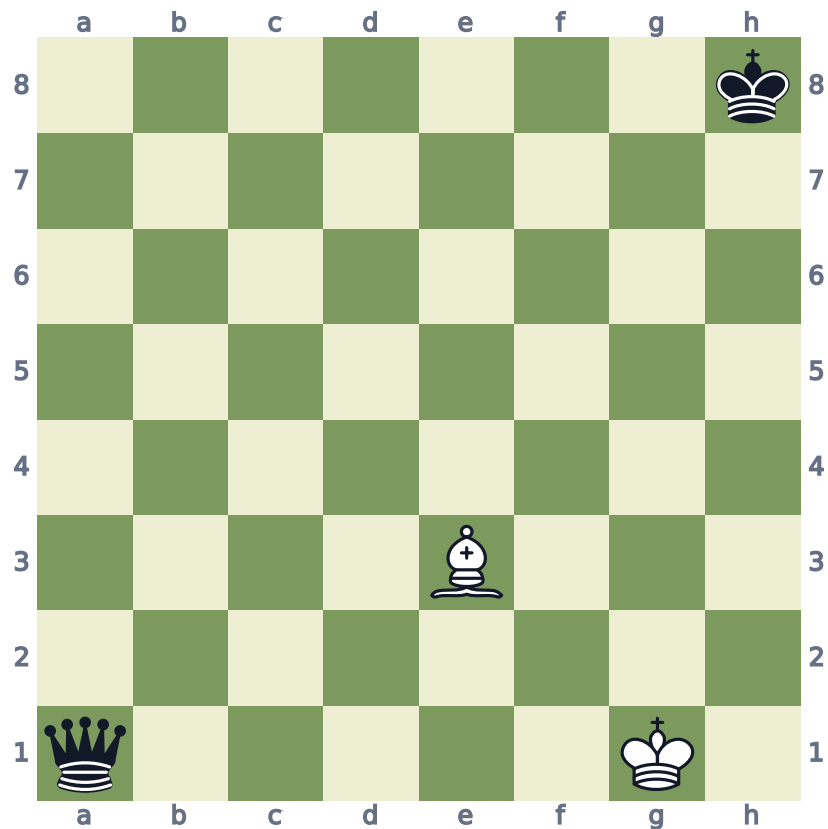
A forcing rook check exposes the queen behind the king. The second engine candidate scores -2.20 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.12.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -2.08 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 13 OF 32

Bishop skewer



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kf2 Kg7 2. Kg3 Qa4 3. Bg5 Qa8 4. Bf4 Kf6 5. Bh6 Qd8

WHY IT WORKS

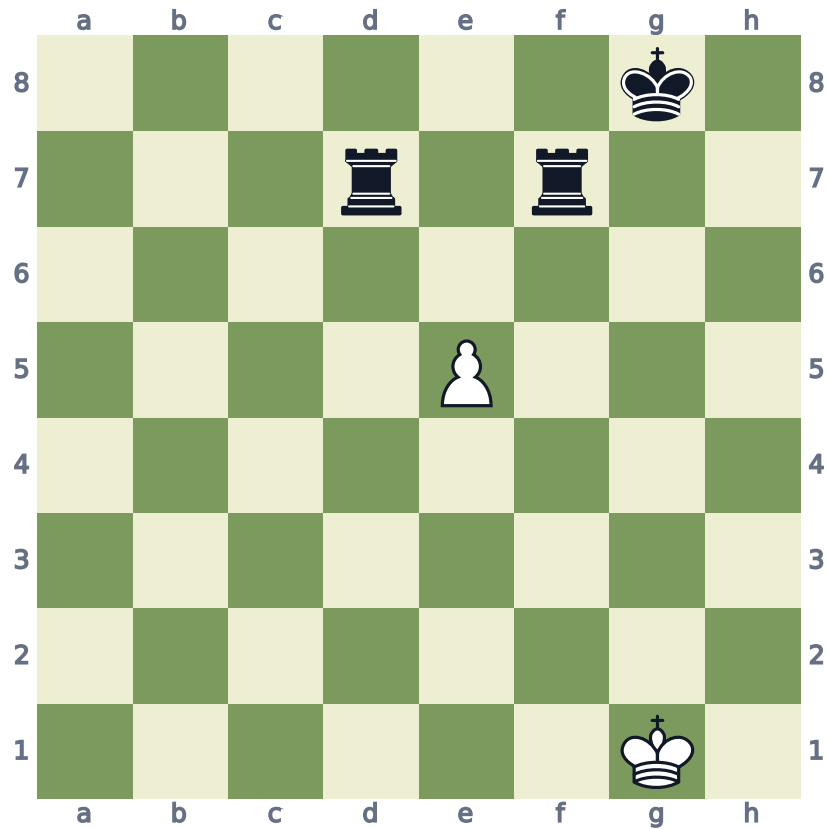
A bishop check places the enemy queen on the same diagonal behind the king. The second engine candidate scores -4.70 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.15.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -4.55 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 14 OF 32

Pawn fork



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kg2 Rfe7 2. Kf3 Rxe5 3. Kg4 Rb5 4. Kf4 Rf7+ 5. Kg4

WHY IT WORKS

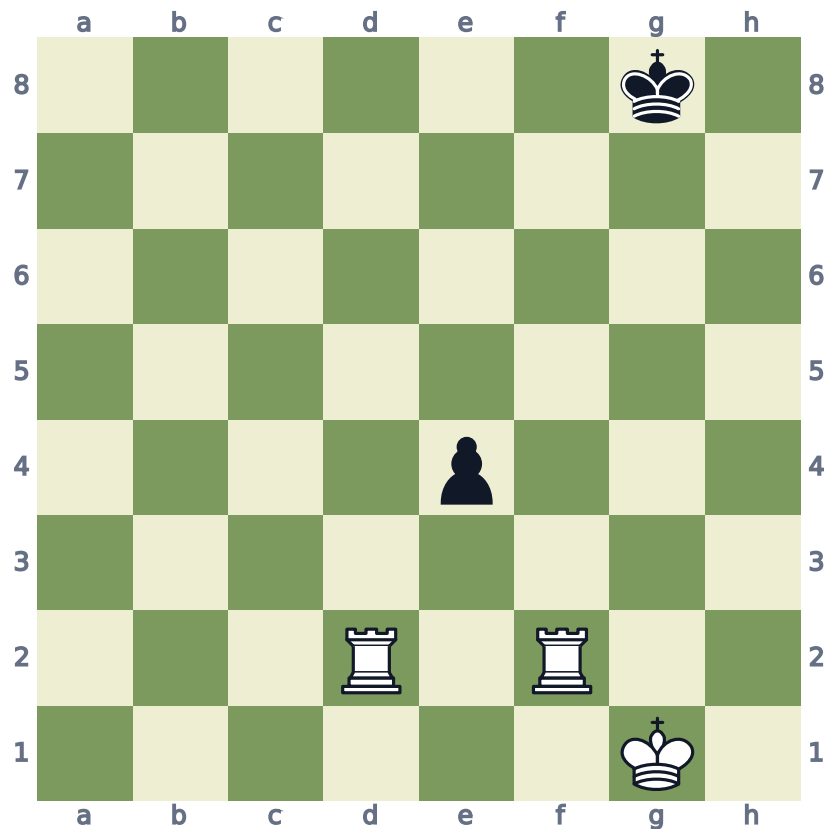
A pawn advance attacks two rooks at once. The second engine candidate scores -6.96 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.21.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -6.75 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 15 OF 32

Pawn fork - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kh7 Rfe2 2. Kg6 Rxe4 3. Kf5 Re1 4. Kf4 Rd4+ 5. Kf5 Rf1+

WHY IT WORKS

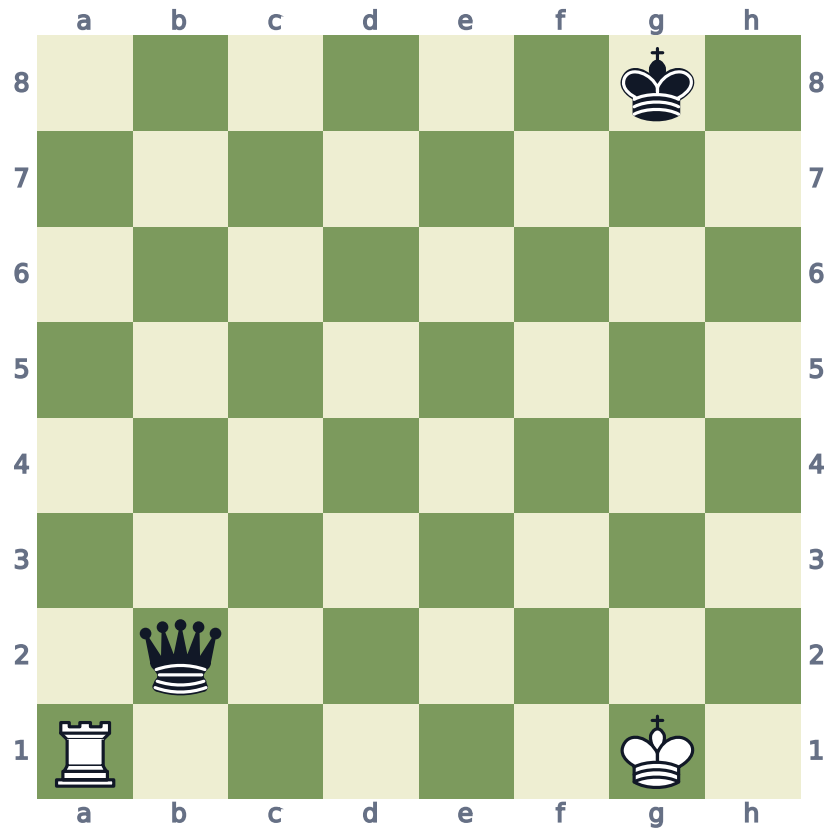
A pawn advance attacks two rooks at once. The second engine candidate scores -6.99 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.07.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -6.92 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 16 OF 32

Capture with check - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Qd4+ Kh2 2. Qxa1 Kg3 3. Qa8 Kh3 4. Qc8+ Kh2

WHY IT WORKS

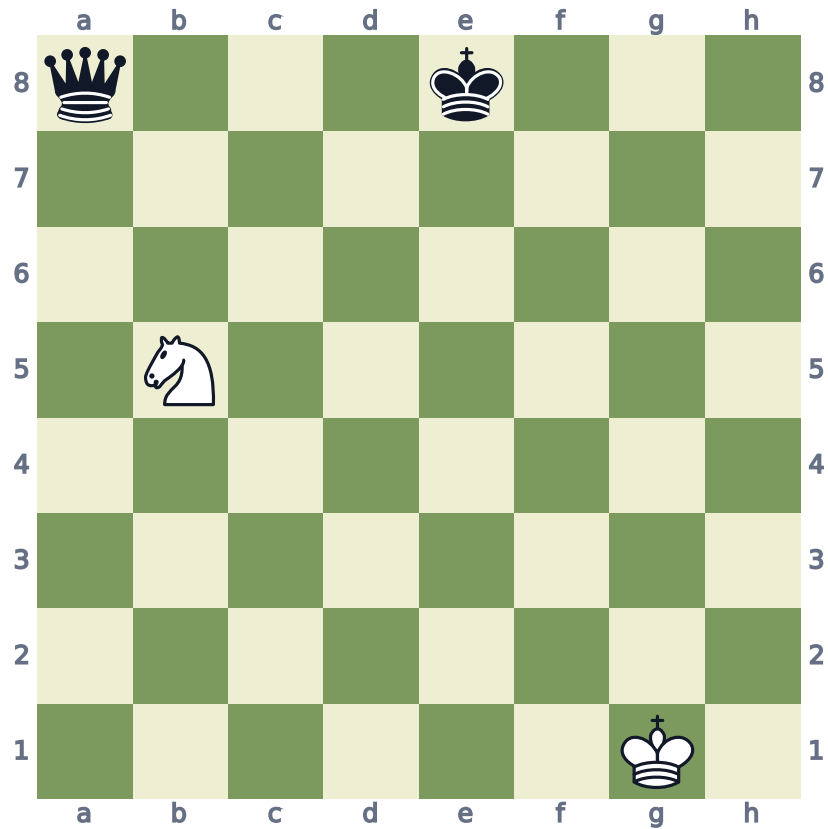
The queen wins a rook while preserving the initiative with check. The second engine candidate scores +5.50 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.16.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.66 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 17 OF 32

Royal fork



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nc7+ Kf7 2. Nxa8 Kg6 3. Kg2 Kh5 4. Kh2 Kg4 5. Kg2 Kf4

WHY IT WORKS

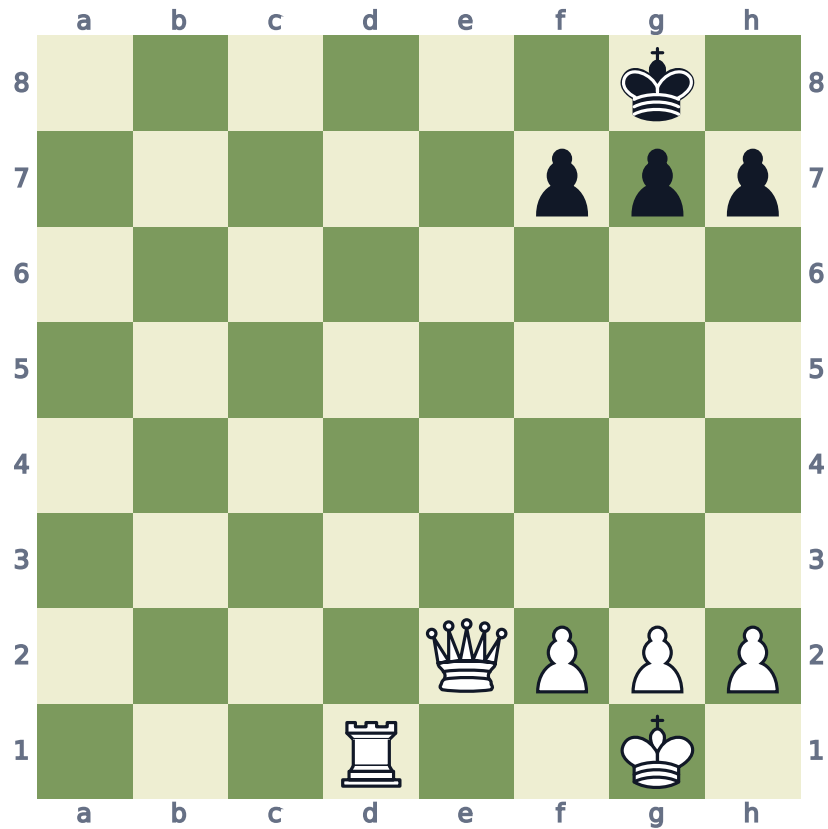
A knight check attacks a second high-value target. The second engine candidate scores -5.38 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 5.12.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -0.26 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 18 OF 32

Back-rank geometry



VERIFIED LINE

1. Qe8#

WHY IT WORKS

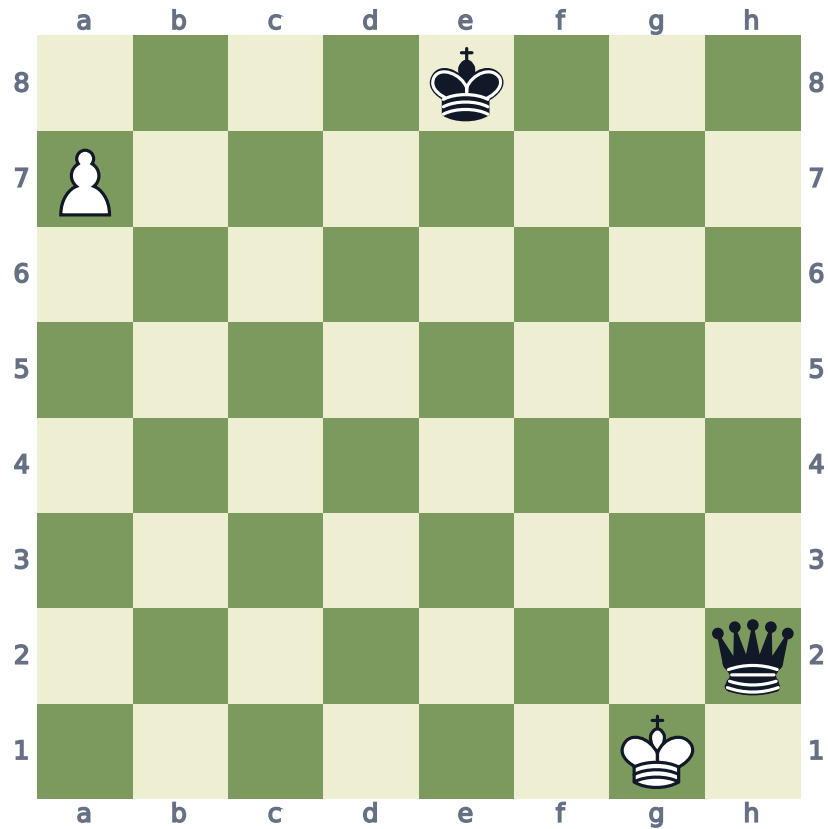
Look for a rook or queen entry against a king without flight squares. The second engine candidate scores mate in 1; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: mate in 1.

SOLUTION 19 OF 32

Promotion tactic



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kxh2 Kd7 2. a8=Q Ke6 3. Kh3 Ke5 4. Qa1+ Ke4 5. Qb1+ Kd4

WHY IT WORKS

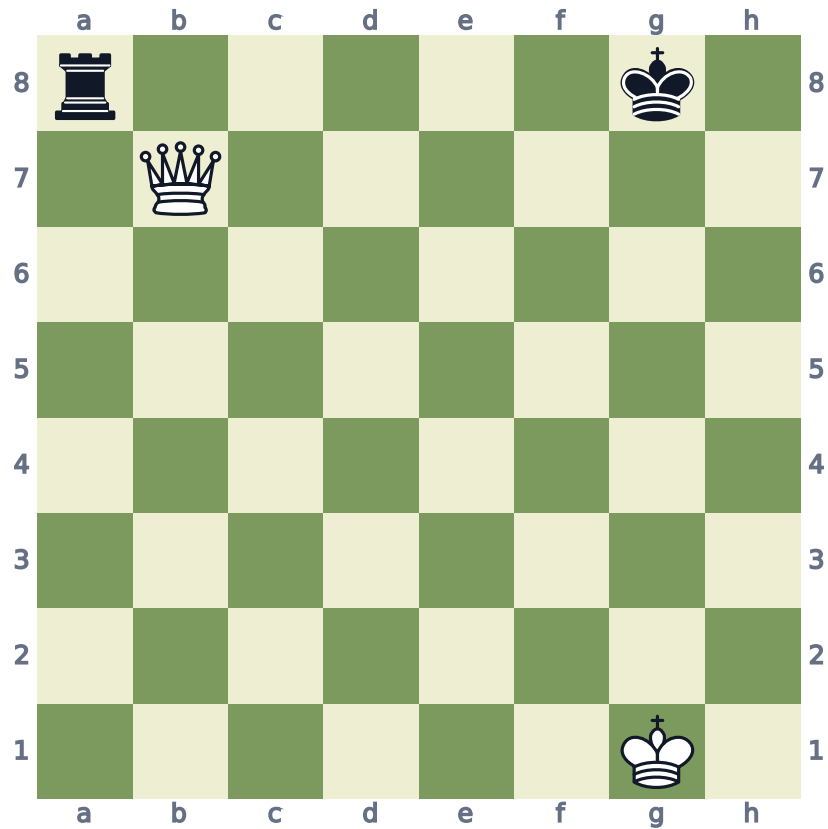
Promotion with check can reverse a material race. The second engine candidate scores -5.39 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 10.62.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.23 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 20 OF 32

Capture with check



VERIFIED LINE

1. Qd5+ Kg7 2. Qxa8 Kg6

WHY IT WORKS

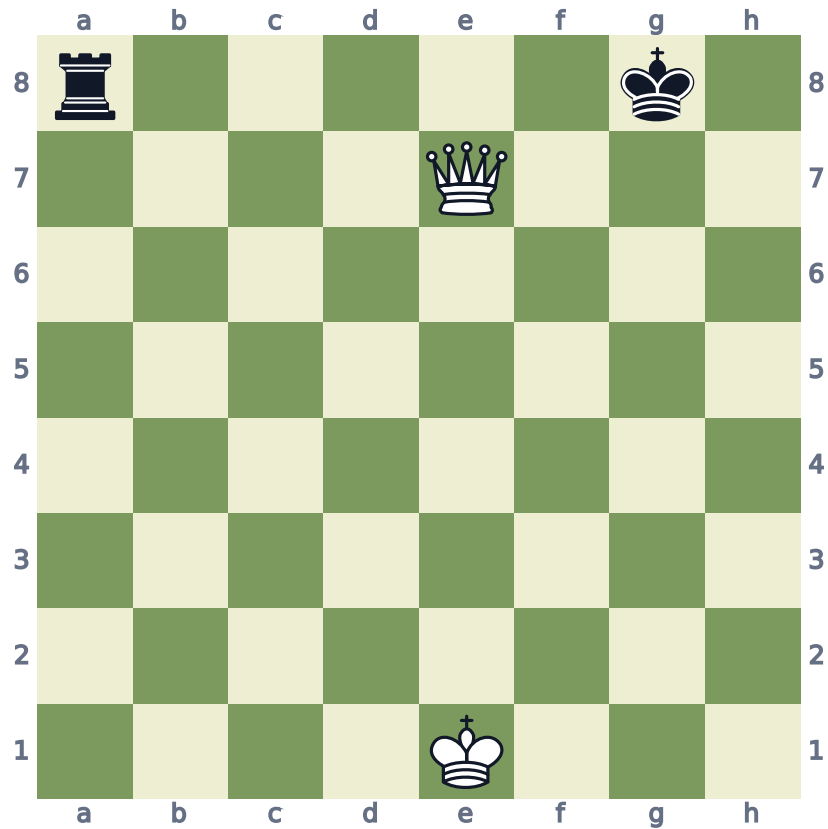
The queen wins a rook while preserving the initiative with check. The second engine candidate scores +5.29 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.19.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.48 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 21 OF 32

Rook double attack - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Ra6 Qd8+ 2. Kg7 Qd4+ 3. Kh6

WHY IT WORKS

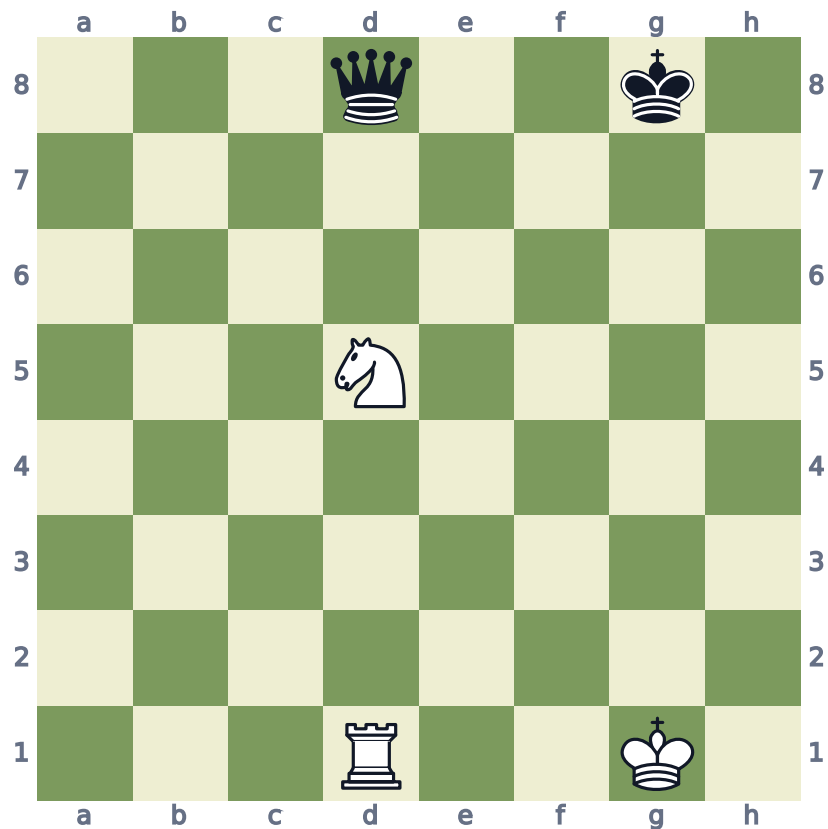
Use a rook check to gain a tempo against another target. The second engine candidate scores -2.46 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.13.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -2.33 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 22 OF 32

Discovered attack



VERIFIED LINE

1. Rd2 Qd6 2. Rg2+ Kh7 3. Ne3 Qf4 4. Rh2+ Kg6 5. Rg2+ Kh6

WHY IT WORKS

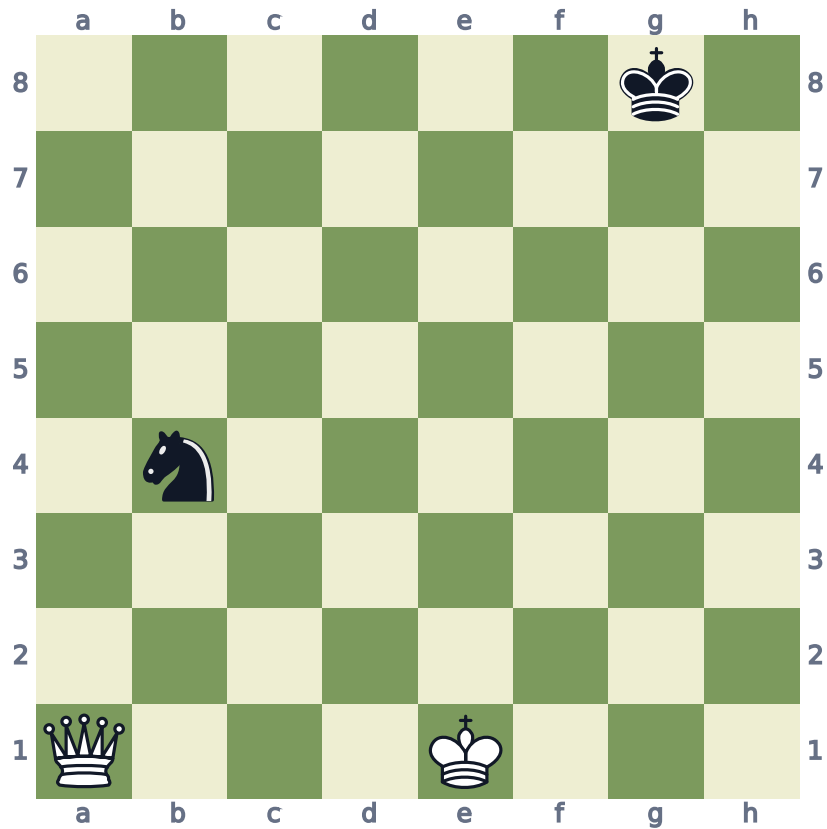
Move the blocker with tempo and reveal the rook's attack. The second engine candidate scores -0.11 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.04.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -0.07 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 23 OF 32

Royal fork - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nc2+ Ke2 2. Nxa1 Kd3 3. Kg7 Kc3 4. Nb3

WHY IT WORKS

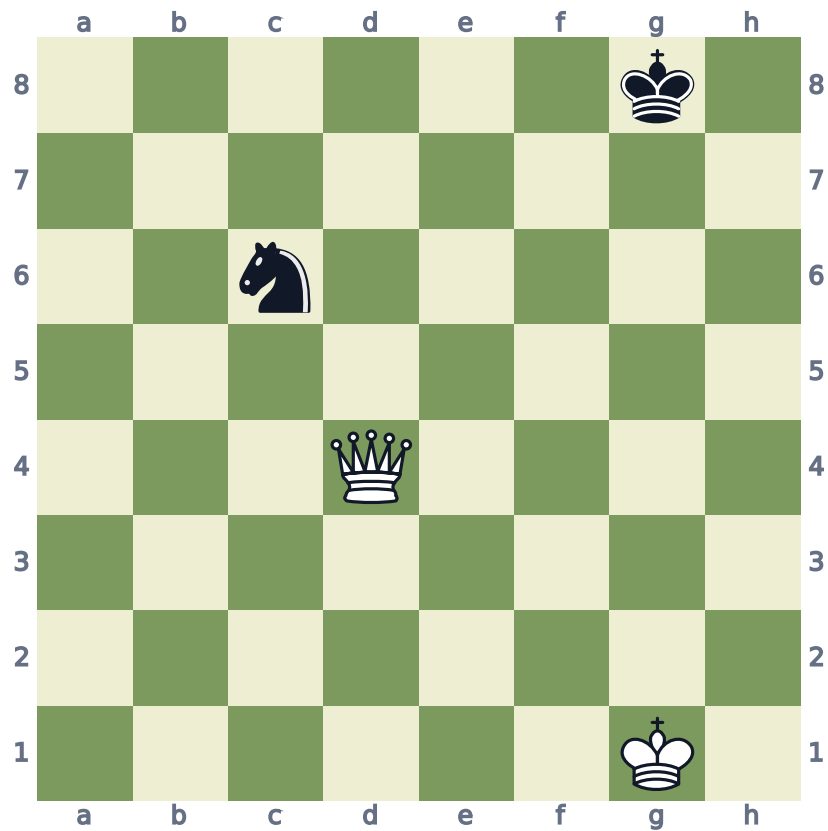
A knight check attacks a second high-value target. The second engine candidate scores -5.40 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 5.22.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -0.18 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 24 OF 32

Loose queen - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nxd4 Kf2 2. Nc6 Ke3 3. Nb4 Kf3 4. Nd5 Kg4 5. Nb4

WHY IT WORKS

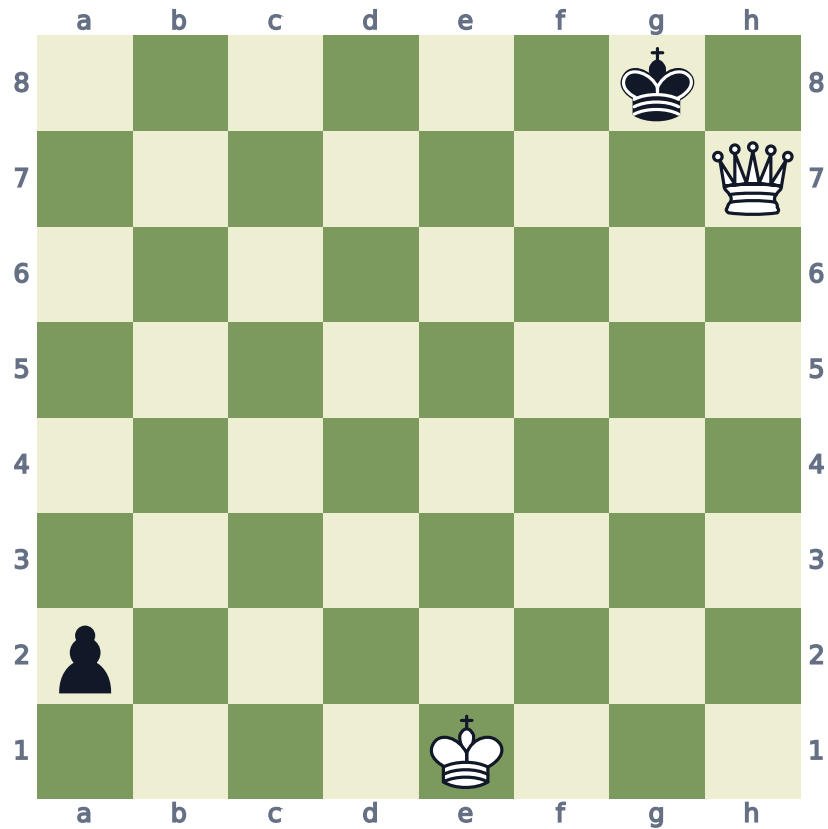
An undefended queen can be won by direct capture. The second engine candidate scores -5.09 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 4.97.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -0.12 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 25 OF 32

Promotion tactic - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kxh7 Kd2 2. Kg7 Kc3 3. a1=Q+ Kb4 4. Qa6 Kc5 5. Qc8+ Kb5

WHY IT WORKS

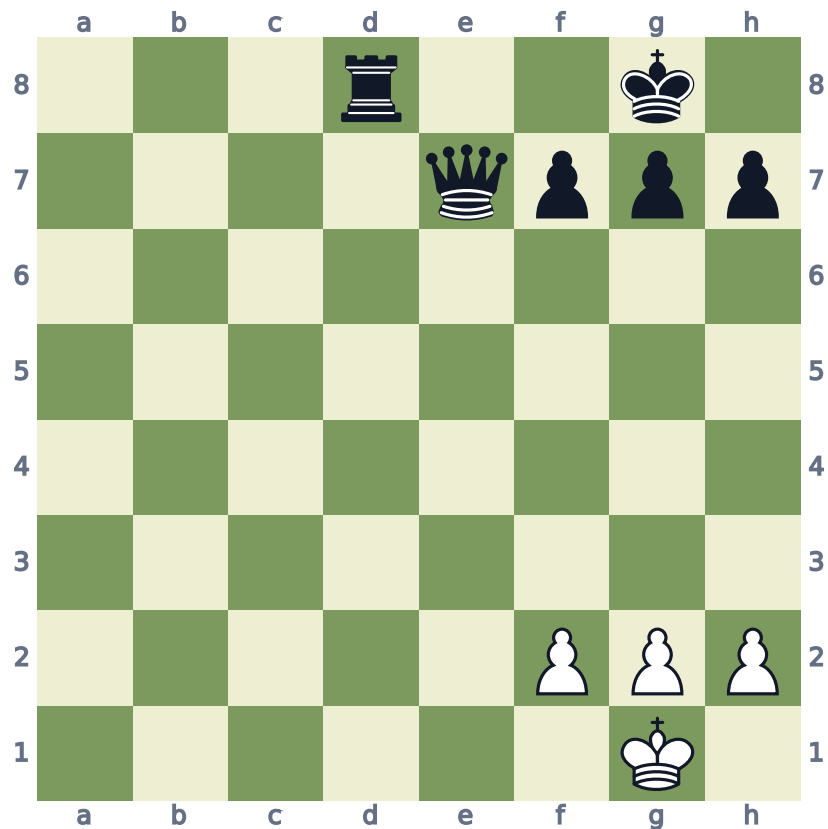
Promotion with check can reverse a material race. The second engine candidate scores -5.09 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 10.31.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.22 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 26 OF 32

Back-rank geometry - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Qe1#

WHY IT WORKS

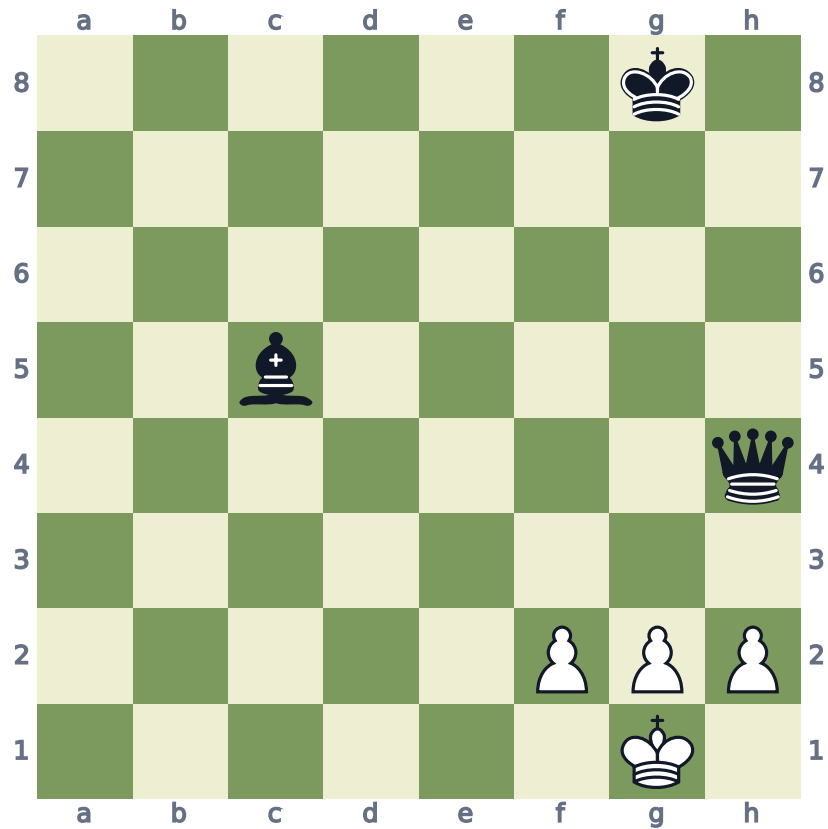
Look for a rook or queen entry against a king without flight squares. The second engine candidate scores mate in 1; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: mate in 1.

SOLUTION 27 OF 32

Removing the guard - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Qxf2+ Kh1 2. Qg1#

WHY IT WORKS

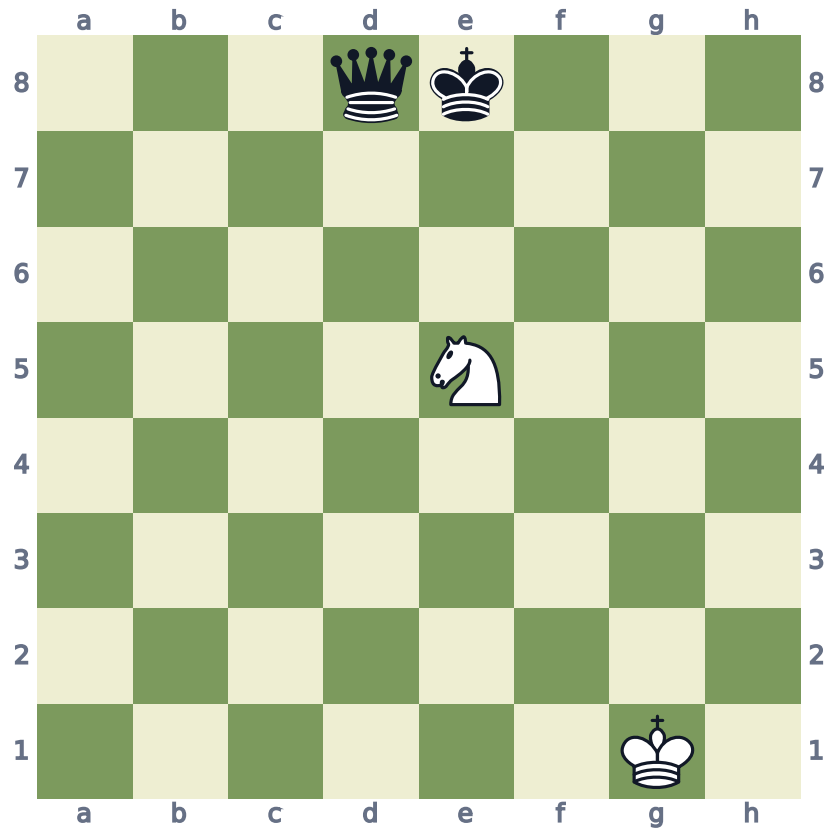
The key capture removes a pawn that also guards the king's shelter. The second engine candidate scores mate in 4; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.02.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: mate in 2.

SOLUTION 28 OF 32

Knight double attack



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nf3 Kd7 2. Kf2 Kc8 3. Nh2 Qc7 4. Nf1 Qb6+ 5. Ke2 Qb2+

WHY IT WORKS

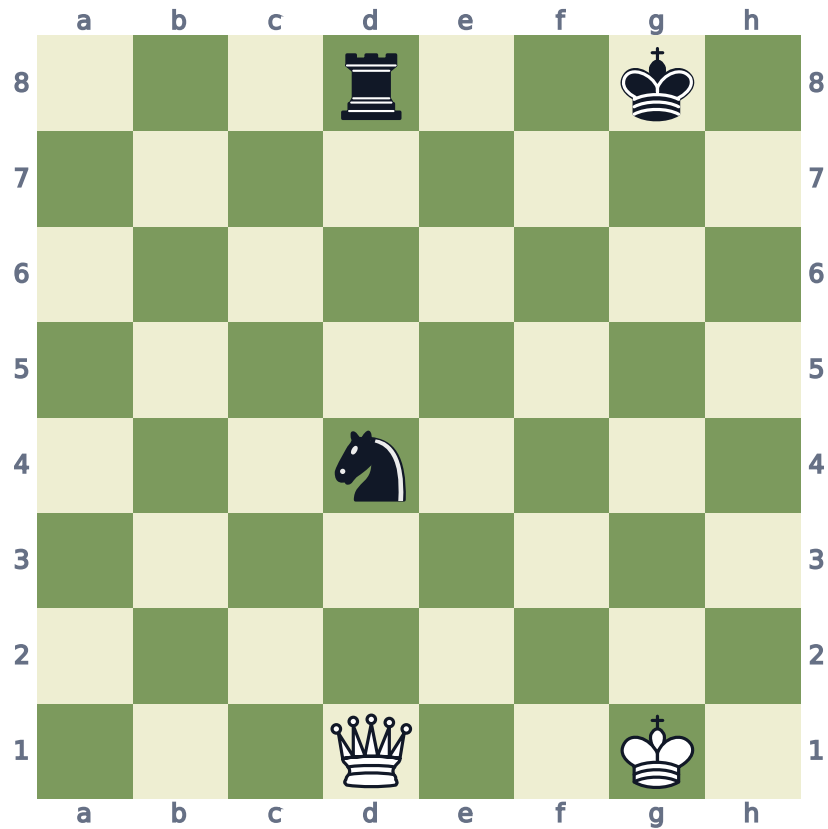
A knight move can attack king and queen simultaneously. The second engine candidate scores -5.40 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.28.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -5.12 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 29 OF 32

Discovered attack - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kf8 Qg4 2. Kf7 Qh5+ 3. Ke6 Kg2 4. Rd6 Qg6+ 5. Kd7 Qe4

WHY IT WORKS

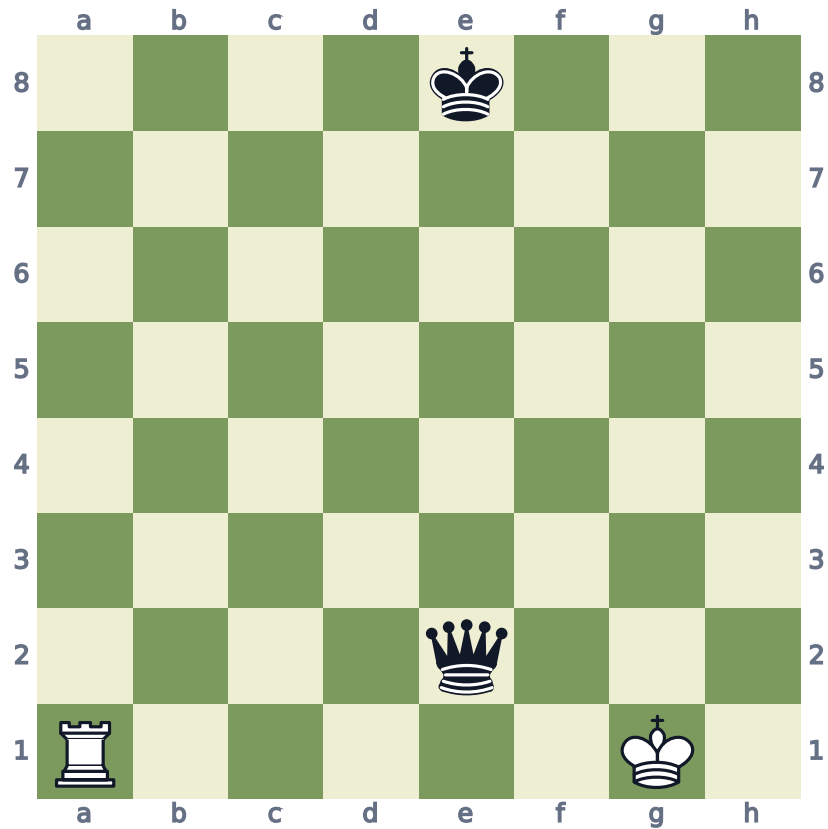
Move the blocker with tempo and reveal the rook's attack. The second engine candidate scores -0.13 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -0.13 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 30 OF 32

Rook double attack



VERIFIED LINE

1. Ra3 Qe1+ 2. Kg2 Qb1 3. Re3+ Kf7 4. Rf3+ Ke6

WHY IT WORKS

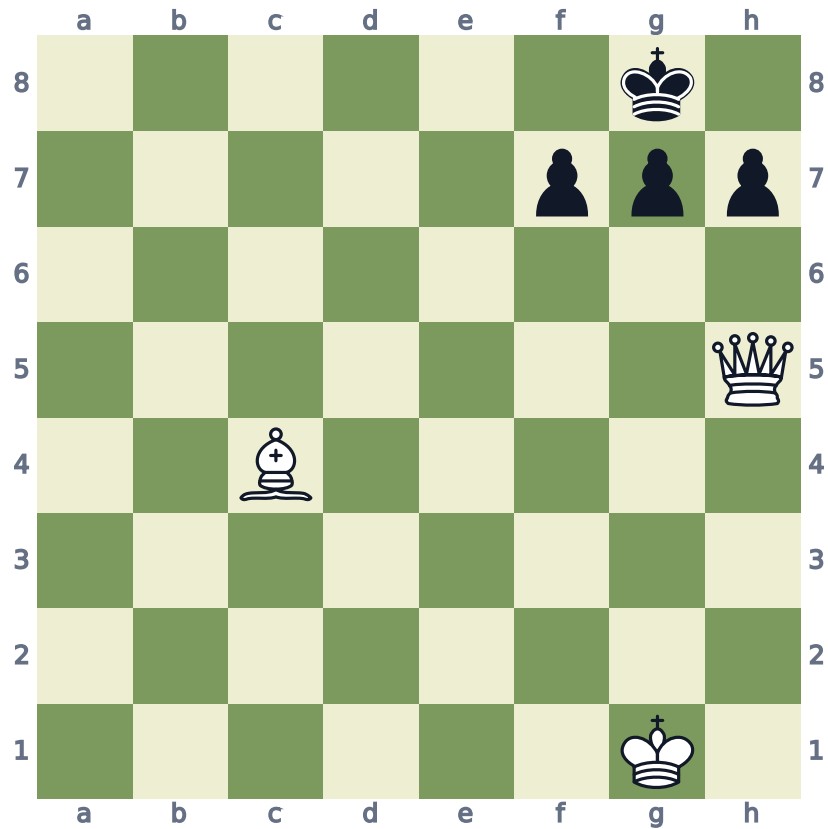
Use a rook check to gain a tempo against another target. The second engine candidate scores -2.50 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.03.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -2.47 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 31 OF 32

Removing the guard



VERIFIED LINE

1. Qxf7+ Kh8 2. Qg8#

WHY IT WORKS

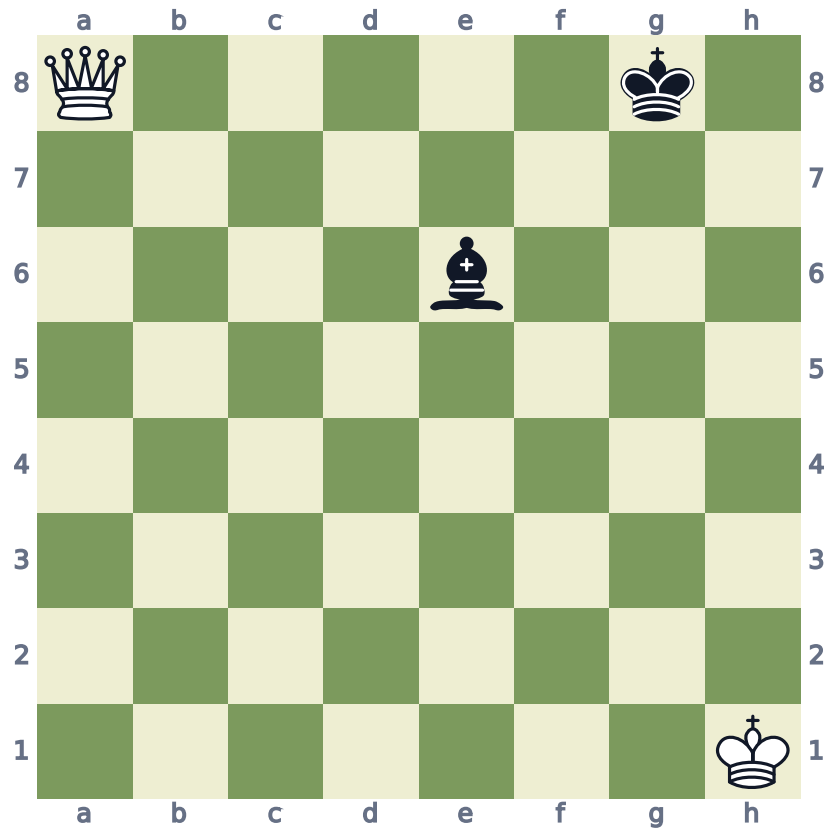
The key capture removes a pawn that also guards the king's shelter. The second engine candidate scores mate in 4; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.02.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: mate in 2.

SOLUTION 32 OF 32

Bishop skewer - reverse view



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kf7 Qa5 2. Kf6 Kg2 3. Bg8 Qa1+ 4. Ke7

WHY IT WORKS

A bishop check places the enemy queen on the same diagonal behind the king. The second engine candidate scores -4.50 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.03.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -4.47 from the side-to-move perspective.

REVIEW

Final mixed review

1

Select five missed positions and solve them in random order without motif names.

2

Explain why the best defense fails in each of those positions.

3

Reverse the board and describe whether the same geometry is still easy to recognize.

4

Find one example of the theme in your own game or a Fritz training game.

5

Retest under a shorter clock only after calculation is accurate without time pressure.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Repeat missed positions tomorrow, then after 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Remove a position only after two correct solutions with a complete explanation.